



SHORT-TERM

Whenever a character gains a short-term madness under the Yellow Crown, they develop a tremendous fear of darkness and an obsession with light. If they do not end their turn in bright light, they have disadvantage on all attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws until the end of their next turn. If they start their turn and aren't in bright light, they must use their movement to reach the closest empty space that is in bright light. If at the end of their movement they aren't in bright light, they must use their action to Dash toward the bright light. If no such space is visible, they can use their movement and action as normal.

LONG-TERM

Gaining a long-term madness during the prolonged exposure to the light of the Yellow Crown has given a character photophobia, and the sheer presence of light is enough to cause them tremendous pain. If a character ends their turn in bright light, they must succeed on a Madness DC Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute, even if they are immune to the poisoned condition. Effects that cure poison, such as the *lesser restoration* spell, can end the condition early, though if they expose themselves again, they'll become poisoned once more.

INDEFINITE

A character that gains an indefinite madness under the Yellow Crown begins to irradiate with incandescent light. Roll a d100; on a result of 33 or lower, the character can harness this light into ephemeral wings of light; if they start their turn in bright light, they can use a bonus action to gain a flying speed of 40 feet until the end of their next turn. On a result of 34 or higher, the character begins to glow uncontrollably, shedding bright light in a 10-foot radius and dim light for an additional 10 feet. While glowing in this way, the character gains no benefit from finishing a short or long rest.

MONSTERS

RULE: COMBINED MONSTER TYPES

If a creature has two creature types, it is susceptible to all effects that would affect either of its types. For example, a creature that is 'humanoid & undead', is susceptible to both the *hold person* spell and the *protection from evil and good* spell.

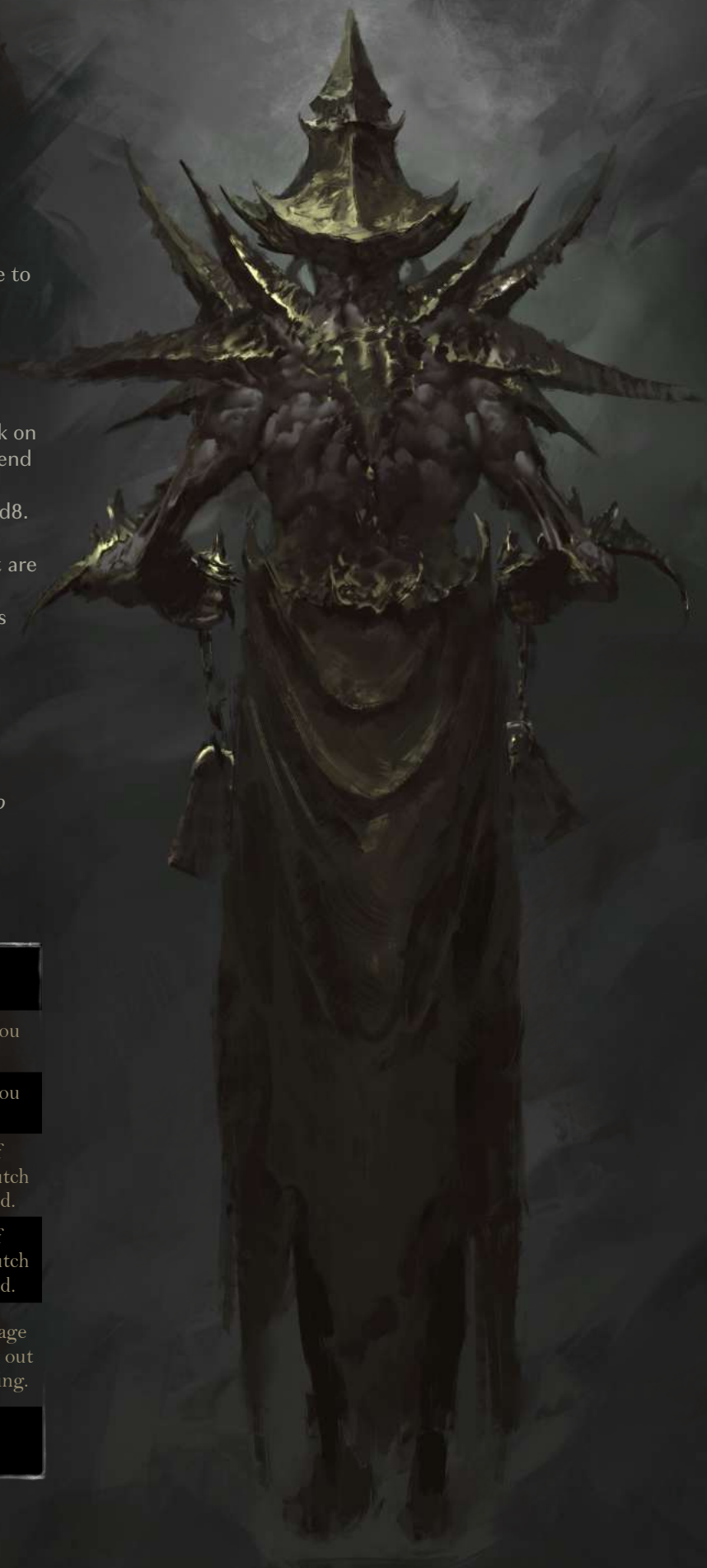
Effects that can affect both creature types don't stack on top of each other. For example, if a creature that is 'fiend & undead' is damaged by a paladin's Divine Smite, it would still only take an additional 1d8 damage, not 2d8.

Finally, due to their warped anatomy, creatures that are 'beast' alongside another creature type **can't** be transformed into (such as via *polymorph* or a druid's Wild Shape).

RULE: LOSING LIMBS

Many monsters and effects in *Steinhardt's Guide to the Eldritch Hunt* can cut off limbs or other body parts. The following table details what happens depending on which limb is cut, unless otherwise specified by the effect:

LIMB	EFFECT
Right Arm	You can't hold anything with two hands and you can hold only a single object at a time.
Left Arm	You can't hold anything with two hands and you can hold only a single object at a time.
Right Leg	Your base walking speed is reduced to 5 feet. If you still have at least one leg, you can use a crutch or cane to move at half your original base speed.
Left Leg	Your base walking speed is reduced to 5 feet. If you still have at least one leg, you can use a crutch or cane to move at half your original base speed.
Gut	You take an additional 11 (2d10) necrotic damage at the start of each of your turns as you bleed out for 1 minute, or until you receive magical healing.
Head	Time to roll a new character. A creature that loses its head dies if it can't live without it.



PARASITIC GEIST

Parasitic geists are defined by their unnerving appearance and insatiable appetite for living creatures. These once-living beings each met a particularly brutal end, often on nights of the hunt, and were cursed by the city to become voracious apparitions. They have become trapped in a never-ending cycle, feeding on the living in an attempt to regain some semblance of their former selves, but in vain.

Parasitic geists lost their bodies along with their minds, resembling floating heads with long, writhing tendrils protruding from their ghostly faces. They use these tendrils as a means of feeding, breaking through the skin of unsuspecting victims and draining their life, guided by nothing more than a visceral hunger. The ethereal appearance of these walking corpses is hard to perceive with the naked eye, flickering in and out of existence, phasing through solid structures.

These monsters are drawn to places where people are experiencing severe emotional or physical pain—grim banquets of blood and agony. Graveyards, battlegrounds, and other locations where death and violence prevail are where they are most often found.



Parasitic Geist

Small undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 11
Hit Points 10 (3d6)
Speed 0 ft., fly 20 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
7 (-2)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

Damage Resistances acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moongilded or silvered

Damage Immunities necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages any languages it knew in life

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The geist can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the geist has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Perception checks that rely on sight.

ACTIONS

Devour Life. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 6 (2d4 + 1) necrotic damage and the geist attaches to the target. While attached, the geist can't use this attack. Instead, at the start of each of the geist's turns, the target takes 6 (2d4 + 1) necrotic damage. The geist moves with the target and can detach as a bonus action.

Fallen Luyarnhian

Medium beast & humanoid (any race), chaotic evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 33 (6d8 + 6)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	3 (-4)	11 (+0)	5 (-3)

Skills Athletics +4

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common (can't speak coherent sentences)

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Keen Hearing and Smell. The fallen has advantage on Perception checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics. The fallen has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the fallen's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Visceral Strike. The fallen deals an additional 4 (1d8) piercing damage when determining the extra damage for a critical hit it scores against a creature with a melee attack.

ACTIONS

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage.

VARIANT: BLOATED NIGHTMARE

Some fallen are bloated with bestial energy from their over-exposure to the Scourge. These fallen are distinguishable from others of their kind by their distended and swollen abdomen. They gain the following trait.

Fallen Echoes. If the fallen is killed by a hostile creature, it explodes in a crimson mist. All creatures that are allied to it within 30 feet of it become enhanced for 2 rounds (on this initiative count, losing initiative ties). Whenever an enhanced creature makes an attack roll, saving throw, or ability check, the target can roll a d6 and add the number rolled to the result.

FALLEN LUYARNHIAN

These dread-filled monstrosities are the harbingers of the Scourge. Uncannily mirroring the appearance of scourgeborne, the fallen Luyarnhians are an abomination born of this dark corruption that began in the Ruby District. Sufficient instincts lingers within them to make them formidable adversaries for the unprepared. They clutch onto torches, a flicker of rationality trying to ward off the encroaching darkness. Yet, this act merely serves to cast long, monstrous shadows, turning the district into a nightmarish landscape.



CORVIAN DWELLER

The corvian dwellers began appearing in the Ruby District, their warped form eerily similar to that of the scourgeborne, like fallen Luyarnhians. Their wings, heavy and matted with grime, are incapable of lifting them high enough to escape the district's confines—a blessing to others, else they'd carry their plague beyond the barricaded borders of the Ruby District.

Corvian Dweller

Medium beast & humanoid, chaotic evil

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points 49 (9d8 + 9)

Speed 30 ft., fly 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	3 (-4)	13 (+1)	4 (-3)

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages -

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Broken Wings. The corvian dweller falls if it ends its turn in the air and nothing else is holding it aloft.

Mimicry. The corvian dweller can mimic simple sounds it has heard, such as a person whispering, a baby crying, or an animal chittering. A creature that hears the sounds can tell they are imitations with a successful DC 11 Insight check.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The corvian dweller makes two attacks: one with its beak and one with its talons.

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Talons. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) slashing damage.

REACTIONS

Wing Flutter. If the corvian dweller's speed isn't 0, and it is targeted by a melee attack, it flaps its wings in defense. It moves 5 feet, and makes a Dexterity saving throw with a DC equal to the attacker's attack roll's total. On a success, it evades completely and the attack misses. On a failure, it halves the attack's damage against itself if the attack hits. This movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks.



Geist

Medium undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 22 (5d8)

Speed 30 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
1 (-5)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)

Damage Resistances acid, fire, lightning, necrotic, thunder

Damage Immunities cold, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained, unconscious

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands all languages it knew in life but can't speak

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Abhorrent Body. The geist can assume either an ethereal or material form. In its ethereal form, it has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks that aren't moon-gilded or silvered. In its material form, it has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from magical attacks that aren't moon-gilded or silvered. The geist can change form as a bonus action. The geist's other traits and actions are determined by its form.

Death Burst (Material Form). When the geist dies, it explodes in a burst of poison. Each creature within 5 feet of it must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw, taking 4 (1d8) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Incorporeal Movement (Ethereal Form). The geist can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object. If it changes to its material form while inside an object, it takes 11 (2d10) force damage and is shunted to the nearest unoccupied space.

Sunlight Sensitivity (Ethereal Form). While in sunlight, the geist has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Perception checks that rely on sight.

ACTIONS

Glacial Touch (Ethereal Form). *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) cold damage. The target must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the creature finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

Rotten Touch (Material Form). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) poison damage and the target must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

GEIST

Geists are two souls intertwined in a solemn dance of despair and suffering. Created by the will of a Great One, these souls ripped from fallen bodies now do their creator's bidding without judgment or rationale. While their appearance differs from typical ghosts, they too glide through the air with the same eerie motions as their undead brethren. Their form twists and changes, capable of resisting even the blows of magical weapons. Their existence is the reason why most hunters carry plain steel weapons as back up.

Dying Breed. When the moon was shattered, most geists broke along with it. This was the undeniable proof that the hunters had the powers to break and end the Scourge afflicting them. In Luyarnha, death offers no respite; a person's body and soul risk becoming the tortured pawns of vile masters, thus the denizens of the city show a fighting spirit rarely seen elsewhere.



ENHANCED PATIENT

Enhanced patients are victims of a macabre surgical practice designed to augment their latent psychic abilities. In an ungodly exchange, their natural sight is forever relinquished, alongside most of their intellect, instead replaced by the chilling cold of the Ocular Apparatus. This metal device, fused directly into the patient's eye socket, opens pathways to metaphysical visions beyond comprehension, linking the frail mortal consciousness with something far greater and more terrifying.

These manipulated individuals, forever blinded to mortal sight, are left suspended in a perpetual state of ethereal revelation, their minds teetering on the brink of cosmic comprehension and madness, bestowing upon them a set of nascent psychic abilities. As living conduits to the cosmos, they form the crux of the Obitus Scholare's ongoing research—the price of their sanity, a small offering for the promise of cosmic enlightenment, holding the key to creating something far greater than meager jaegers.

Enhanced Patient

Medium humanoid (any race), any chaotic

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)

Hit Points 40 (9d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Condition Immunities blinded

Senses tremorsense 20 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands Common but can only speak in short incoherent sentences

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Ocular Apparatus. The device grafted onto the patient's head opens its mind to the beyond. It is blind.

Mad Strength. The patient deals an additional 3 (1d6) psychic damage when it hits with any melee attack. (included in the statblock.)

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The patient makes one attack with its metal limb. On a hit, the patient can make one bite attack against the same target.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage and 3 (1d6) psychic damage, and the patient regains hit points equal to the piercing damage dealt.

Metal Limb. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) bludgeoning or slashing damage (patient's choice) and 3 (1d6) psychic damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Wail of Insanity (Recharge 6). The patient unleashes the chaos within itself. A creature of the patient's choice within 5 feet of it must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or gain a short-term madness.

*"Oh dearest saint, can you hear me? I will be helpful, I swear!
Please don't leave me alone, it's so dark here..."*

ZEALOT

Zealots are fanatical followers of the Radiant Church. The Church believes that the Radiant One holds the key to free Luyarnha of its scourge, just as he brought them enlightenment. As such, these zealots do their utmost to spread their message and gather converts. They know that actions speak far louder than words and as such are always at the forefront of each hunt. They are trained in the art of combat, but they prefer to use their abilities to heal and support their allies, strengthening the faith of their comrades through their unwavering devotion. They are often willing to make the ultimate sacrifice in the name of their deity, if it means saving their kin.

Zealot

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 13 (chain shirt)

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)

Skills Medicine +7, Persuasion +3, Religion +5

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages any two languages

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Spellcasting. The zealot is a 5th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). The zealot has the following cleric spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will): *light, sacred flame, thaumaturgy*

1st level (4 slots): *cure wounds, guiding bolt, silvered shell* †

2nd level (3 slots): *lesser restoration, spiritual weapon*

3rd level (2 slots): *mass healing word, protection from energy*

† SGttEH

Call to Radiance. As a bonus action, the zealot can expend a spell slot to magically imbue its weapons with divine power. Until the end of the turn, its melee weapon attacks deal an extra 10 (3d6) radiant damage on a hit. If the zealot expends a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, the extra damage increases by 1d6 for each level above 1st.

ACTIONS

Mace. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

Despite their peaceful demeanor, zealots are capable of incredible violence, driven by their faith to defend the Radiant Church and its followers. Although their doctrine is one of tolerance, direct insults to their god are deemed heretical and they will not hesitate to use their powers to quiet the offender. They are often seen leading Radiant Church expeditions, accompanied by a retinue of hunters, as they seek to bring the light back to Luyarnha after its fall from grace.

BUTCHER

Cursed-bloods are brave beyond reason, beings willing to go to dangerous lengths to protect their family; butchers are part of the many that have sacrificed more than their lives to defend their loved ones.

Lunar Rebirth. For a cursed-blood, removing their mask causes excruciating pain, akin to the agony of being scalped, before causing a horrific death. One dangerous way of acquiring power is for cursed-bloods to, as they approach the end of their life, perform such an act on a night where the Blood Moon is high. All die immediately, their hearts withering; but for a chosen few, a horrific rebirth is granted. Willful subjects to the twisted influence of the astral body, their flesh contorts and mutates in ways that defy the natural order; the lost twin embedded in their chest is resurrected, and its new eye opens to survey the world from within their abominable form. The transformation isn't without cost, as the cursed-blood's mind fractures and its memories fade away, leaving behind only a fierce bloodlust that compels them to slaughter the aberrant.

Eternal Hunt. Now consumed by eldritch power and stripped of their intellect, they are immune to the creeping tendrils of madness that would drive others to insanity. Before their rebirth is complete, an elder of the tribe bestows upon them a red cloth that covers their face, so that the actions from their new body may not tarnish the previous life they led. The newly birthed butcher soon begins their hunt, relentlessly cleaving the beasts that plague the city, though in their mindless zealotry, they often strike down even those that have yet to transform.

Butcher

Large humanoid & monstrosity, lawful neutral

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points 76 (9d10 + 27)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)

Skills Perception +5

Damage Resistances piercing, bludgeoning and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Condition Immunities madness

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages —

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Aberrant Eye. The butcher has an eye in the middle of its torso that it uses to dispel magic. The eye is closed unless the butcher uses its bonus action to open it, or uses its Dispelling Gaze. At the start of its next turn, it can choose to close the eye (no action required). While closed, the eye is considered behind total cover and is immune to all damage. While opened, the eye has AC 18, 15 HP, and no resistances or immunities, and the butcher has truesight to a range of 60 feet. Any damage dealt to the eye is also dealt to the butcher. If the eye is destroyed, the butcher is blinded and can't use its Dispelling Gaze.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The butcher makes two cleaver attacks.

Cleaver. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage or 18 (2d12 + 5) slashing damage if used with two hand. It can only change its grip at the start of each of its turns.

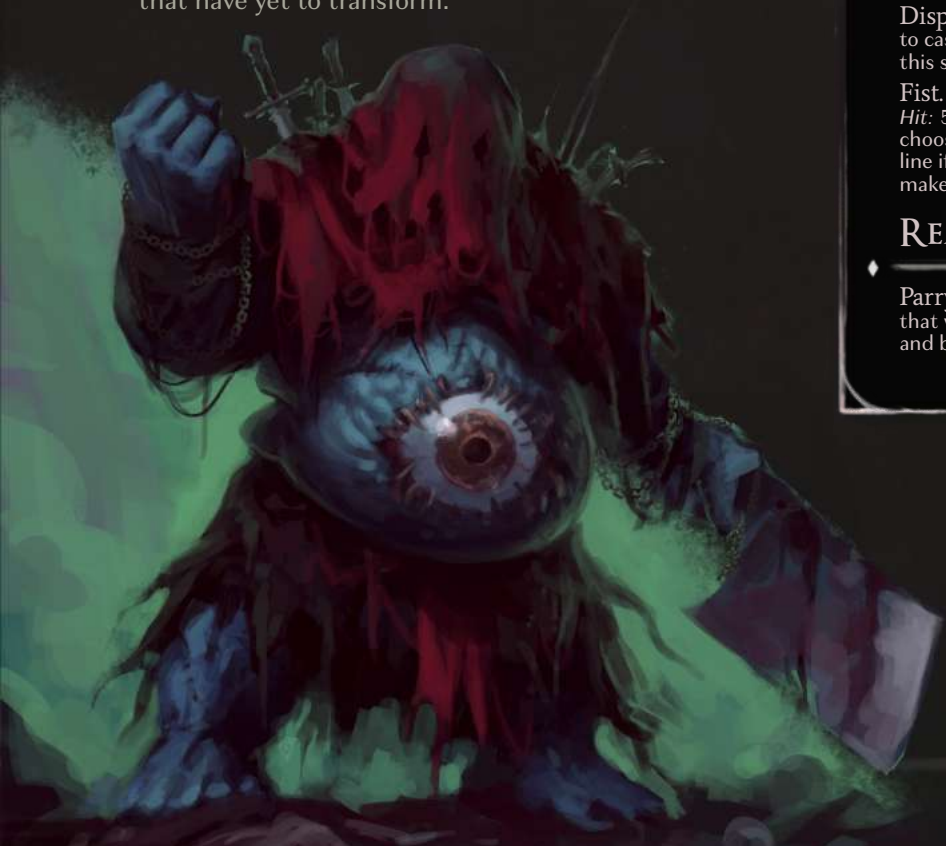
BONUS ACTIONS

Dispelling Gaze. The butcher opens the eye on its chest to cast *dispel magic*. The butcher's spellcasting ability for this spell is Charisma.

Fist. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (2d4) bludgeoning damage and the butcher can choose to push the target back up to 10 feet in a straight line if the target is Large or smaller. The butcher can only make this attack if it has a free hand.

REACTIONS

Parry. The butcher adds 2 to its AC against one melee attack that would hit it. To do so, the butcher must see the attacker, and be wielding a melee weapon.



Scourge Lycan

Medium beast & humanoid, chaotic evil

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 58 (9d8 + 18)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	7 (-2)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Perception +4

Damage Immunities bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages -

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Keen Hearing and Smell. The scourge lycan has advantage on Perception checks that rely on hearing or smell.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The scourge lycan makes two attacks: one with its bite and one with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Devour (Recharge 4-6). The scourge lycan attempts to eat a creature within 5 feet of it. The target must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, the creature is crunched by the werewolf, taking 12 (2d8 + 3) piercing damage and falling prone. The scourge lycan regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.



As the scorching moon rises, beasts become restless, cobbles crack, and the air sizzles with savage suspense. Fiery claws cauterise as they rend, and Luyarnha is choked with the scent of charred flesh.



GUARDIAN GARGOYLE

Lining Luyarnha's many churches, one can find silent sentinels of faith: the guardian gargoyles. These constructs, carved from the very stone that forms the walls and balconies of these hallowed places, are more than mere decoration. For the most part, the gargoyles remain as still and silent as the rocks from which they were wrought, standing sentinel over the sacred spaces they protect, their unblinking eyes ever watchful and their monstrous visages a stern warning to those who might dare to defile the sanctity of the church. However, when such sanctity is threatened or the lives of those within its walls are in peril, these seemingly inert creatures are roused to life. Animated with the divine words of the clergy, they move with a singular purpose: to defend the church and its congregation.

As they spring into action, the stone forms of the gargoyles become supple and agile, their wings unfurling to reveal the full extent of their might, before swooping down upon their enemies with the wrath of the divine. Once their duty is complete, the guardian gargoyles return to their stone slumber, resuming their silent watch over the churches they were birthed to protect.

Guardian Gargoyle

Medium construct, lawful good

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 60 (8d8 + 24)

Speed 30 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	7 (-2)	11 (+0)	3 (-4)

Skills Perception +4

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moongilded or silvered

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, frightened, petrified, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages understands Celestial but can't speak

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

False Appearance. While the gargoyle remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from an inanimate statue.

Warding Strikes. When the gargoyle hits a creature with an attack, it can mark the creature until the end of the gargoyle's next turn or until the creature is marked by another gargoyle. While it is within 30 feet of the gargoyle, the marked creature has disadvantage on attack rolls that don't target the gargoyle.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The gargoyle makes two attacks: one with its bite and one with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) slashing damage.

Boulder. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d10 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

REACTIONS

Stone Defense. When another creature within 5 feet of the gargoyle takes damage, the gargoyle can partially turn it to stone, giving the target resistance to the triggering damage type(s) until the start of the target's next turn.



Hunter

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 17 (splint)
Hit Points 58 (9d8 + 18)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +5, Perception +2

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages any one language (usually Common)

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Flexible Combatant. When the hunter draws or stows a weapon, it can draw or stow another weapon with the other hand. It can reload weapons with the loading, reload, or barrel properties without a free hand.

Additionally, if the hunter is carrying a one-handed melee weapon in one hand, and a one-handed ranged weapon in the other hand, it doesn't have disadvantage on attack rolls with ranged weapons from being within 5 feet of a hostile creature.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The hunter makes two longsword attacks. If it has a firearm drawn, it can also make a firearm attack.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Firearm. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 60/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Dodge Step (3/Short Rest). If the hunter's speed isn't 0, and it is targeted by an attack, it dodges in defense. It moves 5 feet, and makes a Dexterity saving throw with a DC equal to the attacker's attack roll's total. On a success, it evades completely and the attack misses. On a failure, it halves the attack's damage against itself if the attack hits. This movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks.

HUNTER

The motto of hunters is "survive together, or die together." They never hunt alone, unless they are forced to. After all, even the oft considered greatest hunter, Steinhardt, was always accompanied by Vicar Priscilla on all his hunts. The nights in Luyarnha can be brutal and the beasts relentless, and only a united front can hope to survive.

All jaegers are hunters, but not all hunters are jaegers. Where jaegers are relentless killers, hunters are often simple citizens wishing to protect their homes and those they love. They are often the first to perish, but fear the one who lives long in a profession where men die young. Hunters are an invaluable contribution to the survival of the city-state and its denizens, and successful hunters cut down hundreds of beasts throughout their life before succumbing to the fires of battle.



Razorblade Bitzer

Medium construct, unaligned

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 75 (10d8 + 30)

Speed 40 ft.

STR **DEX** **CON** **INT** **WIS** **CHA**

16 (+3) 16 (+3) 16 (+3) 4 (-3) 11 (+0) 1 (-5)

Skills Athletics +5, Investigation +1

Damage Immunities poison, psychic

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands the languages of its master(s) but can't speak

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Illumination. The bitzer sheds bright light in a 5-foot radius and dim light in an additional 5 feet.

Immutable Form. The bitzer is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Instilled Loyalty. The bitzer can't act in a manner that is harmful to its master(s).

Necrotic Negation (1/Day). When the bitzer takes necrotic damage, it instead takes no damage.

Whirligig Saw. A creature that the bitzer is grappling takes 5 (2d4) slashing damage at the start of each of its turns and the bitzer's turns.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The bitzer makes two melee attacks, only one of which can be with its bite

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 3) piercing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 13). Until this grapple ends, the bitzer can't bite another target.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage.

Tail. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.



Hunting dogs had been used for centuries in Luyarnha: for retrieving partridges, rounding up wild boar, and even as attack hounds by the city watch. However, all of these canines required a master, and all left the bones and inedible guts of their prey festering in fly-covered mounds. The Radiant Church needed an autonomous creature with fewer dietary scruples, one that would lick the cobbles clean of blood and decayed flesh alike.

Using the technology of manikin creation, the Scions fused flesh to metal, creating a construct-canine with an insatiable appetite: razorblade bitzers. Released in the wake of a hunter's pursuit, or after an eldritch incursion decimates a neighborhood, these bitzers consume all. Bones were broken, liquids lapped up, and the gaze of Luyarnhians is protected from the brutality of the events that transpired the night before.

Although the eldritch runes carved upon the steel of their skin ensures the loyalty of these hounds to the Church, many still roam the streets, forgotten and masterless. Only in death does their duty end.

RAZORBLADE BITZER

When the hunts first began, they were kept under wraps, only to be executed under cover of the night. Hunters swore an oath of secrecy to the Radiant Church: none were to speak of the Scourge; rumors would spread more virulently than a plague ever could. But the hunters were warriors, not propagandists, and thus the Scions, hungry for favors from the top, offered their help with creating a means of removing any trace of the horrors that occurred each night.

Screechwing

Medium beast & humanoid, chaotic evil

Armor Class 17 (half plate)

Hit Points 58 (9d8 + 18)

Speed 20 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15(+2)	16(+3)	14(+2)	3(-4)	12(+1)	7(-2)

Damage Resistances acid

Senses blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 11

Languages —

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Disorienting Strikes. The screechwing has advantage on attack rolls against deafened creatures.

Echolocative Vision. The screechwing can see creatures it has hit with its Echoing Screech attack within the last minute past its blindsight range, up to 120 feet, and regardless of cover.

Swift Swordsmanship. After the screechwing hits a creature with a weapon attack, the screechwing can take the Disengage action as a bonus action that turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The screechwing makes two attacks with its shortswords.

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Screech (Recharge 4-6). The screechwing lets out a powerful screech in a 90-foot cone. Each creature in the area must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or take 9 (2d8) thunder damage, become stunned until the end of its next turn, and become deafened for 1 minute. A deafened creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

SCREECHWING

With wings that stretch the breadth of a grown man and sharp blades that can rend flesh from bone, a dire fate awaits any who dare cross paths with this warped creature. It is a stalker unparalleled, a being consumed by the very essence of fear that seeks solace in the embrace of darkness. Fortuitously, the denizens of Luyarnha rarely glimpse this monstrosity, for its senses far surpass those of sane mortals, rendering it vulnerable to the raucous cacophony and blinding luminescence of the bustling city-state. Instead, it lurks within the shadowy depths of the forests surrounding the metropolis, biding its time.

Fallen Scourgeborne

Once a mere vespertilio, this beast has been twisted by madness, its soul devoured by the very darkness it sought refuge within. The vestiges of its humanoid features have been distorted into a grotesque visage, its eyes aglow with a feral hunger as it stalks its quarry. Yet despite its monstrous appearance, the screechwing takes to the skies with a grace that belies its savagery, its acute senses guiding it to its prey with lethal precision. Employing its ear-rending shriek, it deafens all who hear, leaving them disoriented and vulnerable to its relentless assault.

Abductor

Medium aberration & humanoid, lawful evil

Armor Class 16 (studded leather)

Hit Points 84 (13d8 + 26)

Speed 25 ft., climb 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	19 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +4

Skills Acrobatics +6, Athletics +6, Stealth +6

Damage Resistances cold, fire

Conditions Immunities charmed

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages understands Deep Speech but can't speak

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The abductor makes two bushwhack attacks.

Bushwhack. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) bludgeoning damage. If the target is surprised, this attack is a critical hit.

Abduct. The abductor places an unconscious Medium or smaller creature within 5 feet of it into its body by opening the jaw located in its abdomen, abducting it. The abducted creature has total cover against effects outside the abductor and remains unconscious until released from the abductor's body. If the creature is dying, it becomes stable but can't gain hit points while in the abductor's body. If the abductor dies, or if it uses an action to release the abducted creature, the creature is released in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the abductor. The abductor can have only one creature abducted at a time.

Darklight Candle. The abductor casts *darkness* at 3rd-level, without material components, targeting its candle. While touching the candle, a creature can see through the darkness created by the spell.

BONUS ACTIONS

Empower (Recharge 5-6). The abductor draws on dark powers. The next time it hits a creature with a melee attack before the end of its next turn, the target must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, the target falls unconscious for 1 minute. The target repeats the saving throw whenever it takes damage and at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Nimble Escape. The abductor takes the Disengage or Hide action.

ABDUCTOR

In the moonlit nights of Luyarnha, deformed humanoids loom, their monstrous forms stalking unsuspecting prey, abducting them as test subjects for their masters' heinous rituals and experiments. These wretched beings are called abductors—altered cursed-bloods bound in eternal servitude to the Obitus Scholare.

Short and gaunt, shrouded in darkened robes, its mouth sewn shut, each abductor carries a candle, an enchanted light that burns its soul to cloak its twisted flesh in shadows. Despite their fragile appearance, abductors possess unparalleled strength, their power enough to subdue even skilled warriors. Rarely do they employ lethal force, preferring to incapacitate their targets before devouring them with the ravenous maw of their conjoined twin, tucking them safely within the confines of their abdomen before delivering them unto their new home.

Revenant Bear

Large beast & undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 110 (13d10 + 39)

Speed 40 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	2 (-4)	13 (+1)	7 (-2)

Skills Perception +3

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities acid, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages —

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Emaciated Appetite. The bear is in a state of constant hunger. After hitting a non-construct creature with an attack, the bear eats part of it, regaining 8 (1d10 + 3) hit points.

Hold Breath. The bear can hold its breath for 3 hours.

False Appearance. While motionless and partly submerged in water or acid, the bear is indistinguishable from a normal mound of dirt.

Spiked Body. Whenever a creature within 5 feet of the bear hits it with a melee attack, the creature takes 5 (2d4) piercing damage.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The bear makes two snapjaw attacks.

Snapjaw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (3d6 + 4) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14). Until this grapple ends, the bear can't make snapjaw attacks against another target, and the target takes an extra 7 (2d6) damage when it's hit by this attack.

REVENANT BEAR

On the outskirts of Luyarnha, there once stood a human village, soon to be engulfed by a cruel tragedy of fate, as their village was consumed by a catastrophic wave of corrosive acid, washing over their homes and extinguishing the lives within. The unbearable pain and despair that overtook them in their final moments cracked open the doors of their minds and souls, inviting a curse to take bed within.

As their mortal forms were twisted and broken by the relentless onslaught of acid, the curse seized upon their anguish, warping their beings into monstrous shapes. In place of the stalwart villagers, there now stood grotesque, undead bears, their singed fur barely concealing the corroded skeletons beneath. The disfiguration they had suffered in their death persisted in these new forms, a macabre testament to the catastrophic demise that had befallen them.

Now, these cursed beings lurk in the desolate acidic waters that swallowed their village, their anguished spirits consumed by the power that had claimed them. Driven by the lingering rage and despair of their human lives, these bears have become fearsome predators, their presence a warning for any intruder who dare venture into their forsaken homes.



Ryan Bittner

When the moon rises over the decaying remnants of the village, mournful howls echo through the barren landscape.



The wisp liege reigns over its lesser kin, its malevolent influence turning their harmless pranks into malefic acts. Under the liege's rule, the wisps' misdirections grow vicious and calculated. No longer are they merely content in leading travelers astray; they now revel in their ensuing demise, echoing the darkness within their sovereign.

WISP LIEGE

Will-o'-the-wisps are capricious sprites that delight in misleading the unwary, guiding them from the security of trodden paths and into the perilous embrace of the wilderness. Yet, when forests brim with hatred, a strange phenomenon occurs. This collective animosity converges, taking form into a singular, more potent entity known as a wisp liege, an embodiment of the wisps' evil spirits. After the cataclysm of the First War, such monsters began to dwell within the forests surrounding Luyarnha. It was as if the dark magic unleashed in that conflict had infused the land itself, altering its essence.

Wisp Liege

Large undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class 15 (natural armor)
Hit Points 68 (8d10 + 24)
Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	15 (+2)	17 (+3)	2 (-4)	13 (+1)	6 (-2)

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +5
Damage Resistances necrotic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Damage Immunities acid, lightning
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
Languages —
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Wispfather. While within 60 feet of the liege, a will-o'-wisp, can use its shock attack an additional time on each of its turns as a bonus action.

Dying Whisper. Whenever a will-o'-wisp is reduced to 0 hit points within 60 feet of the liege, the liege regains 5 hit points and gains advantage on its next attack roll before the end of its next turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The liege uses its Create Wisps (if available), then makes two attacks with its claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage plus 1 slashing damage for each will-o'-wisp within 5 feet of the target.

Create Wisps (Recharge 6). The liege opens its mouth to let out 1d4 will-o'-wisps. They share its initiative, but take their turn immediately after the liege's. The liege can command them telepathically (no action required by the liege), and they will follow its commands.

REVILED HOUND

Even though the Obitus's engineering of the jaegers was praised for its scientific brilliance, they quickly discovered that they needed more to slake their insatiable thirst for knowledge. They shifted their attention to canines after observing the amazing advancements the Scions had achieved in developing the Razorblade Bitzers. After all, why couldn't the flesh of mongrels be altered if that of humans, elves, and even manikins could?

One of the few breeds with the strength to endure exposure to the primordial serum, the same serum which was used to awaken the powers of jaegers, is the Doberman Pinscher.

However, like many of the earliest hunters, their bodies were incapable of handling the excess power, irrevocably mangling them.

Rare are the ones that hunt alongside these 'reviled hounds'. In fact, only those who have been trained to see past outward appearances can comprehend that these pups, despite their horrifying features, will remain devoted, even if it means their deaths.





Reviled Hound

Medium beast & aberration, unaligned

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)
Hit Points 84 (13d8 + 26)
Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)	4 (-3)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Str +6, Con +5

Skills Perception +2

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moonlighted or silvered

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands Common but can't speak

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Protective Instinct. If the hound is not blinded, it has advantage on its initiative roll.

Crushing Grasp. Creatures the hound is grappling have disadvantage on attack rolls against it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The hound makes three attacks, only one of which can be with its bite.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 3) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14) if it is a Large or smaller creature. The target must also succeed on a DC 12 Intelligence saving throw or gain a short-term madness. Until the grapple ends, the hound can't bite another target.

Tentacle. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14) if it is a Large or smaller creature. Until the grapple ends, the hound can't use this tentacle on another target. The hound has five tentacles.

Eldritch Tethers (Recharge 3-6). If the hound isn't grappling any creatures with its tentacles, it can make a tentacle attack against up to five creatures within reach. Each attack must target a separate creature.



SCORCHED ADJUDICATOR

Failed Experiments

In their lust for power, the Obitus Scholare lead gruesome experiments, merging the flesh of soldiers with that of eldritch beings. Their labor gave birth to powerful combatants, and a sea of corpses. Scorched adjudicators are the fruits of such experiments, humanoids that couldn't become true warriors, failing to resist the call from beyond and losing their sanity. Yet, the scholars still found a use for these failures: they now act as perfect killers for their creators.

Enforcers of Justice

Adjudicators enforce justice, more specifically, the brand of justice approved of by the Obitus Scholare. Indeed, these abominations are dispatched to remove any threat to the order; their otherworldly powers trapping the souls of their victims and ensuring an irreversible death. The murderous intent of these monsters is apparent in battle; they delight in causing suffering and their deadly instincts prevents healing. Deriving a twisted sense of pleasure from their hunts, adjudicators often carry the shrunken, decapitated heads of their victims as horrific mementos.

Scorched Adjudicator

Medium aberration, chaotic evil

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 91 (14d8 + 28)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	9 (-1)	17 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +5

Skills Acrobatics +5, Athletics +7, Perception +5

Damage Resistances fire, necrotic

Condition Immunities blinded

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages -

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Guiding Light. The adjudicator sheds dim light in a 10-foot radius. When a creature starts its turn in the light, or enters it for the first time on a turn, it gains disadvantage on Charisma saving throws until the start of its next turn.

Limited Telepathy. The adjudicator can magically communicate ideas, emotions, and images telepathically with any creature within 120 feet of it. This form of telepathy doesn't allow the receiving creature to telepathically respond.

Reactive. The adjudicator can take one reaction on every turn in combat.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The adjudicator makes two handaxe attacks.

Handaxe. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage. On a hit, if the adjudicator isn't within 5 feet of the target, the adjudicator can teleport to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the target.

Soul Tear. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (4d8 + 3) necrotic damage and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Charisma saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken.

This reduction lasts until the creature finishes a long rest. If this effect reduces a creature's hit point maximum to 0, the creature dies. A creature killed by this reduction can't be resurrected until the adjudicator is killed.

Inferno (Recharge 4-6). Flames pour down from the adjudicator's wings. Each creature between 10 and 40 feet of the adjudicator must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

REACTIONS

Snuff Out the Light. When a spell that restores hit points is being cast within 120 feet of the adjudicator, the adjudicator teleports to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the caster and makes a handaxe attack against it with advantage. On a hit, the spell fails and has no effect.



It is said that Vicar Priscilla is the only person in Luyarnha who was able to tame such a wondrous creature...

ALES NEBULAE

Lone Travelers

From the day it manifests into existence, until the day it is laid to rest, an ales nebulae has but one purpose, to find its lifelong partner, and to protect it until death. It travels the vast cosmos in search of the one to fill the void within, erring through the stars, for centuries, often in vain. Its whole existence could be considered a cruel cosmic joke. Yet, it does not falter, and its search continues.

Vassals of Gravity

Its mysterious birth in the cosmos grants an ales nebulae powerful, and sometimes uncontrollable, gravitational powers. The other-worldly bird is able to invert gravity for a brief moment and bend the fabric of reality to teleport around, yet it can't control the crushing field of gravity it emits, preventing all from approaching it. All, but the one it's life was destined for.

Ales Nebulae

Large monstrosity, lawful neutral

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 102 (12d10 + 36)

Speed 5 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	17 (+3)	17 (+3)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	12 (-1)

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +6, Survival +7

Damage Resistances force; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities exhaustion

Senses darkvision 180 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages —

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Flyby. The ales nebulae doesn't provoke opportunity attacks when it flies out of an enemy's reach.

Gravity Field. The ales nebulae emits a gravitational field. The area within 30 feet of it is difficult terrain for other creatures.

Innate Spellcasting. The ales nebulae's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

3/day: *misty step*

1/day: *dimension door*

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The ales nebulae makes three attacks: one with its beak and two with its talons. It can use erupting spikes in place of one or both attacks with its talons.

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Talons. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Erupting Spike. The ales nebulae causes the earth to erupt into sharp stones below the feet of a creature that it can see on the ground within 90 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw or take 9 (2d8) piercing damage.

Invert Gravity (Recharge 5-6). The ales nebulae's speed becomes 0 until the start of its next turn. Each creature within 15 feet of the ales nebulae must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature is lifted 10 feet in the air and is stunned until the start of the ales nebulae's next turn. Any creature that enters the area during that time must also make the saving throw. At the start of the ales nebulae's next turn, gravity reverts again and all stunned creatures are slammed down, taking 27 (8d6) bludgeoning damage and falling prone. On a successful save, a creature can move up to half its speed until it is no longer in the area. If it doesn't leave the area, it suffers the effects of a failed save.

DULLAHAN

Dullahans owe their dreadful existence to the Circle of Symbiosis. When one of their own members dares to betray the sacred circle, they are condemned to the grim fate of becoming a dullahan. The transgressor is bound to an ancient stone altar, where, beneath the cold gaze of the moon, their head is severed in an act of macabre justice—yet life doesn't leave their body.

Relentless Huntsmen. Unleashed into the world as a headless harbinger, the newly created dullahan is then merged with an undying steed and tasked with a dark purpose: to hunt. Their prey vary—for some, innocent individuals to be kidnapped from their everyday lives, and others, adversaries of the Circle, marked for death. The Circle's knowledge of their targets is eerily accurate, and so, once the dullahan sets its sightless gaze upon a target, relenting isn't an option that exists.

Scorned by Radiance. The price of transmutation into a dullahan is steep. The unholy essence that fueled their headless form etches an irreversible mark on their soul. Even when restored to their living state, they bear this cursed taint, which stands in stark opposition to the divine energies that brim in many places of worship. When a dullahan dares to breach the boundaries of these hallowed grounds, their bodies immediately ignite in a roaring blaze, punished by the radiant powers above.

Eternal Curse. Should the dullahan weather its gruesome task and pay off the debt of its soul, the Circle takes it upon themselves to decide the creature's destiny. Some are mercifully put to rest, their spectral existences snuffed out as abruptly as they began. Others, who've shown their penitence throughout their servitude, are deemed worthy of a second chance. These fortunate few are restored to their former state, reinstated as druids in the Circle, but forever marked by the scars of their ordeal.

Dullahan

Large undead, lawful evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 95 (10d10 + 40)

Speed 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	17 (+3)

Skills Athletics +7, Intimidation +6, Perception +5

Damage Vulnerabilities bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from moonlight attacks

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moonlight.

Damage Immunities necrotic

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened

Senses blindsight 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages understands Common but can't speak

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Accursed Beacon. The dullahan knows the exact location of creatures that are under the effect of its spells as long as they are on the same plane of existence.

Innate Spellcasting. The dullahan's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). The dullahan can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material or somatic components:

At will: *bane*, *brittle bone throw*[†] (2d8, 2d4), *chill touch* (2d8), *knock*

2/day each: *hex* (5th level, damage can't break the dullahan's concentration), *malicious rancor*[‡]

Relentless Advance. The dullahan is unaffected by difficult terrain and can move over water and other liquids. It can't willingly enter consecrated areas such as churches; it takes 22 (4d10) radiant damage at the start of each of its turns while within such an area.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dullahan makes two attacks with its spine whip.

Spine Whip. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d4 + 4) slashing damage and 13 (3d8) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

BONUS ACTIONS

Cunning Action. The dullahan takes the Dash, Disengage, or Hide action.

REACTIONS

Maddening Sight. When a creature within 30 feet of the dullahan targets it with an attack or spell, the dullahan can force the creature to gaze into its severed head. The target must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or become blinded for 1 minute and gain a short-term madness. A blinded creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the blinded condition on a success.

VARIANT: TREE STRIDE AMULET

To enter in and out of fortified walls, many dullahans are bestowed a **tree stride amulet**.

Tree Stride Amulet.

Requires attunement by an undead.

While wearing it, you can use an action to expend one charge and cast the **tree stride** spell from it. You can also bring along one creature of your size or smaller when you move between trees using that spell. You must be grappling the creature to do so.

This amulet has 3 charges, and regains 1 expended charge daily at dawn.



LIVING ARTILLERY

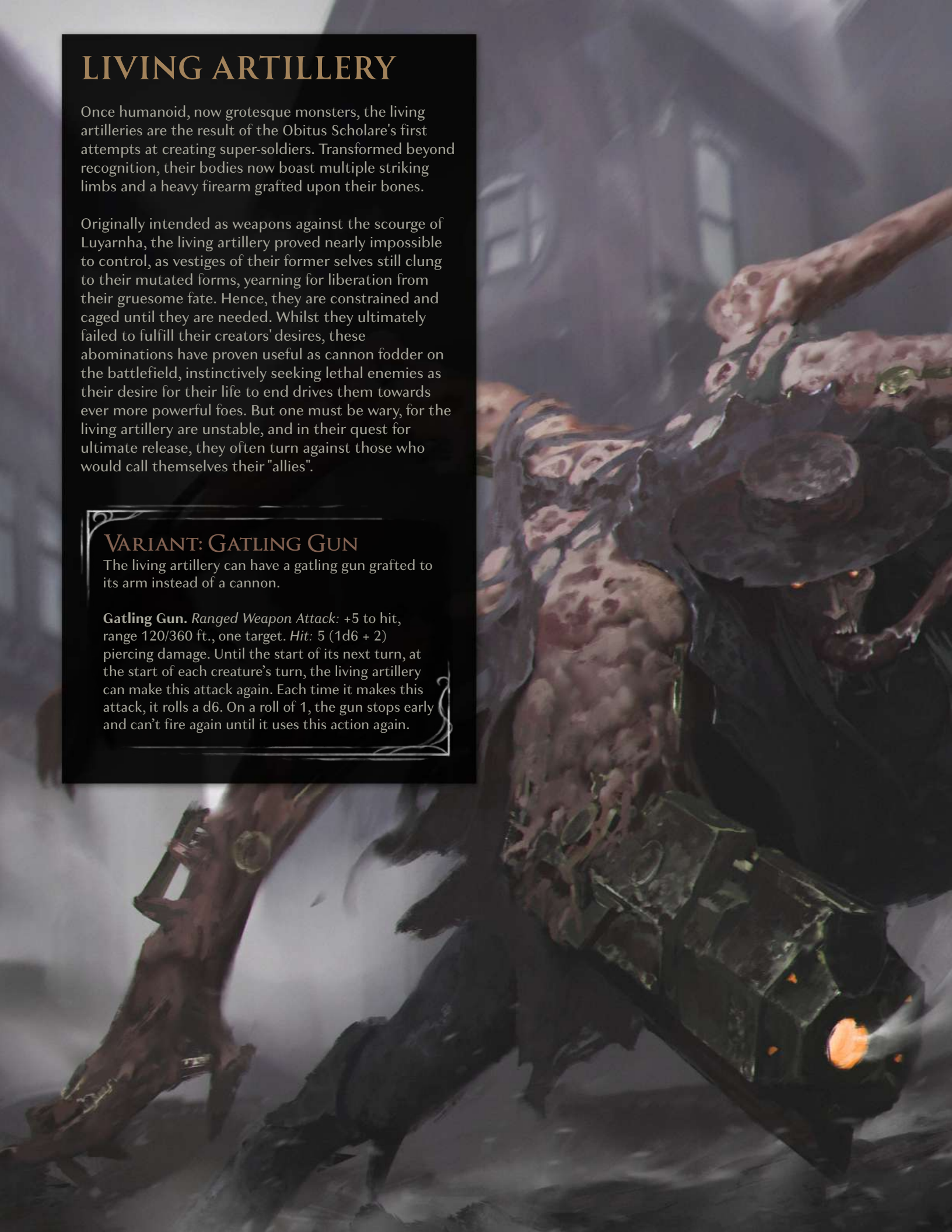
Once humanoid, now grotesque monsters, the living artilleries are the result of the Obitus Scholare's first attempts at creating super-soldiers. Transformed beyond recognition, their bodies now boast multiple striking limbs and a heavy firearm grafted upon their bones.

Originally intended as weapons against the scourge of Luyarnha, the living artillery proved nearly impossible to control, as vestiges of their former selves still clung to their mutated forms, yearning for liberation from their gruesome fate. Hence, they are constrained and caged until they are needed. Whilst they ultimately failed to fulfill their creators' desires, these abominations have proven useful as cannon fodder on the battlefield, instinctively seeking lethal enemies as their desire for their life to end drives them towards ever more powerful foes. But one must be wary, for the living artillery are unstable, and in their quest for ultimate release, they often turn against those who would call themselves their "allies".

VARIANT: GATLING GUN

The living artillery can have a gatling gun grafted to its arm instead of a cannon.

Gatling Gun. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 120/360 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage. Until the start of its next turn, at the start of each creature's turn, the living artillery can make this attack again. Each time it makes this attack, it rolls a d6. On a roll of 1, the gun stops early and can't fire again until it uses this action again.



Living Artillery

Large aberration & humanoid, chaotic neutral

Armor Class 14 (studded leather)

Hit Points 112 (15d8 + 45)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	3 (-4)	13 (+1)	3 (-4)

Saving Throws Con +6

Skills Acrobatics +8, Athletics +8

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Damage Immunities fire

Condition Immunities exhaustion

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages —

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Freedom of Movement. The living artillery ignores difficult terrain, and magical effects can't reduce its speed or cause it to be restrained. It can spend 5 feet of movement to escape from nonmagical restraints or being grappled.

Grappler. The living artillery has advantage on attack rolls against any creature grappled by it.

Self-Destruct. When the living artillery is reduced to 0 hit points, its unstable body detonates. Each creature within 20 feet of the living artillery must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 28 (8d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The living artillery makes four attacks: three with its tentacles and one with its cannon.

Tentacle. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (3d4 + 2) slashing damage. Instead of dealing damage, the living artillery can grapple the target if it's a creature (escape DC 16). The living artillery can have up to three creatures grappled at a time.

Cannon. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 120/480 ft., one target. *Hit:* 21 (3d12 + 2) piercing damage and the living artillery rolls a d6. On a roll of 3 or higher, the ammunition detonates and each creature within 10 feet of the target must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw or take 9 (2d8) fire damage. Flammable objects in the area take 9 (2d8) fire damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Engage. If the living artillery has all its hit points, it moves up to its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

NIGHTMARE CENTIPEDE

These nightmarish entities, with an unsettling multitude of writhing limbs producing a continuous, disquieting clatter, are truly a sight to unhinge the mind. Even when seemingly at rest, their bodies appear to be in constant flux, ceaselessly shifting and pulsating in a grotesque dance of flesh and tendons, exuding a noxious miasma—a toxic byproduct of their repugnant feasts.

Nightmare Denizens. Mercifully, the city of Luyarnha has been spared direct contact with these abominations, confined as they are to nightmare realms, unable to breach into the Material Plane. They are grotesque echoes of the absurdity that infests the

dreams of the dormant Great Ones. Nightmare centipedes have the ability to ensnare entire communities caught adrift in the nightmare realms, causing them to disappear without trace. Whether these lost souls are consumed or subjected to some other fate is a chilling unknown.

Hive Minds. A single nightmare centipede is sufficiently worrisome, but they become exponentially more dangerous when they gather, forming a collective consciousness. This hive mind amplifies their intellect and their lethality, coordinating their movements and strategies with terrifying efficiency.

Nightmare centipedes produce a subsonic chittering noise, a sound beyond the auditory capabilities of most species, that serves as a communication tool, and as something far viler. They can use this sound to exert control over creatures weaker than themselves, particularly insects and other many-legged beasts, compelling these underlings to enact their gruesome will. Their unfortunate victims can do little more than writhe in agony as a horde of spiders, ants, centipedes, and cockroaches swarm over them, burrowing into their flesh and consuming them from within.



Nightmare Centipede

Large aberration, unaligned

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 120 (16d10 + 32)

Speed 40 ft., climb 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	15 (+2)	15 (+2)	6 (-2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +4

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +8

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities poisoned, madness

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages —

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Abhorrent Presence. When a creature starts its turn within 60 feet of the centipede, the creature must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. If the creature has never encountered a centipede before, it gains a long-term madness on a failure, or a short-term madness on a success. A creature that has encountered a centipede before gains a short-term madness on a failure, and no madness on a success.

Hive Mind. Nightmare centipedes share a bond with other members of their hive that enhances their abilities. As long as a centipede is within 60 feet of at least one other centipede, it has advantage on initiative rolls and Perception checks. If one centipede is aware of a particular danger, all others in the hive are, too. No centipede in a hive mind is surprised at the beginning of an encounter unless all of them are. In addition, a centipede gains a bonus to attack and damage rolls equal to the number of centipedes within 60 feet of it (maximum +5).

Otherworldly Communication. The centipede can communicate via subsonic sounds with other aberrations, aquatic creatures with 6 or less Intelligence, and insects within 60 feet of it. This is a silent and instantaneous mode of communication that the other creatures can understand. As a bonus action, the centipede can use this trait to control and give orders to one creature or swarm of creatures (e.g. a swarm of insects) of CR 1 or lower that understands it within 60 feet of it.

Inexorable Movement. When the centipede moves into the space of a creature that is Large or smaller, the target must succeed on a DC 15 Athletics or Acrobatics check (creature's choice) or become grappled by the centipede. The centipede can grapple up to 100 creatures and its speed isn't halved by grappling creatures.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The centipede makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its pincers.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) piercing damage and 6 (1d12) poison damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute. A poisoned creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

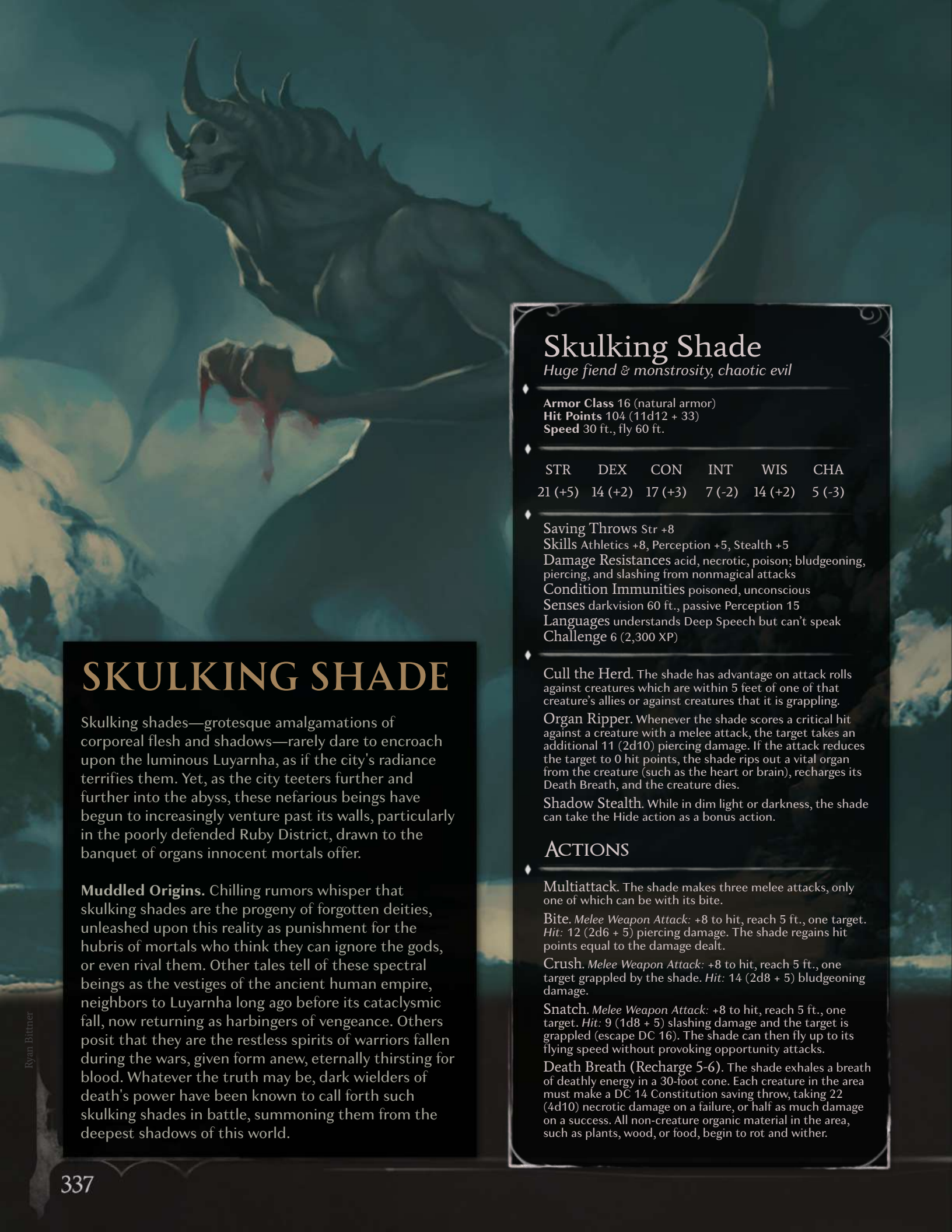
Pincer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage and 3 (1d6) poison damage. The centipede has advantage on the attack roll if it is grappling the target.

BONUS ACTIONS

Crawl. The centipede moves up to its speed.

REACTIONS

Regurgitate (Recharge 5-6). After being hit by an attack, the centipede exhales a stream of acidic ichor in a 40-foot line that is 5 feet wide. Each creature in that area must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 26 (4d12) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.



SKULKING SHADE

Skulking shades—grotesque amalgamations of corporeal flesh and shadows—rarely dare to encroach upon the luminous Luyarnha, as if the city's radiance terrifies them. Yet, as the city teeters further and further into the abyss, these nefarious beings have begun to increasingly venture past its walls, particularly in the poorly defended Ruby District, drawn to the banquet of organs innocent mortals offer.

Muddled Origins. Chilling rumors whisper that skulking shades are the progeny of forgotten deities, unleashed upon this reality as punishment for the hubris of mortals who think they can ignore the gods, or even rival them. Other tales tell of these spectral beings as the vestiges of the ancient human empire, neighbors to Luyarnha long ago before its cataclysmic fall, now returning as harbingers of vengeance. Others posit that they are the restless spirits of warriors fallen during the wars, given form anew, eternally thirsting for blood. Whatever the truth may be, dark wielders of death's power have been known to call forth such skulking shades in battle, summoning them from the deepest shadows of this world.

Skulking Shade

Huge fiend & monstrosity, chaotic evil

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 104 (11d12 + 33)

Speed 30 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	14 (+2)	17 (+3)	7 (-2)	14 (+2)	5 (-3)

Saving Throws Str +8

Skills Athletics +8, Perception +5, Stealth +5

Damage Resistances acid, necrotic, poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities poisoned, unconscious

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages understands Deep Speech but can't speak

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Cull the Herd. The shade has advantage on attack rolls against creatures which are within 5 feet of one of that creature's allies or against creatures that it is grappling.

Organ Ripper. Whenever the shade scores a critical hit against a creature with a melee attack, the target takes an additional 11 (2d10) piercing damage. If the attack reduces the target to 0 hit points, the shade rips out a vital organ from the creature (such as the heart or brain), recharges its Death Breath, and the creature dies.

Shadow Stealth. While in dim light or darkness, the shade can take the Hide action as a bonus action.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The shade makes three melee attacks, only one of which can be with its bite.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 5) piercing damage. The shade regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

Crush. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target grappled by the shade. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Snatch. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 16). The shade can then fly up to its flying speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Death Breath (Recharge 5-6). The shade exhales a breath of deathly energy in a 30-foot cone. Each creature in the area must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw, taking 22 (4d10) necrotic damage on a failure, or half as much damage on a success. All non-creature organic material in the area, such as plants, wood, or food, begin to rot and wither.

DREADCROW

Of all beings that relish in the terror they cause, dreadcrows are among the most foul, embodying the worst fears of those who behold them. A dreadcrow's body is illusory, constantly changing and shifting to reflect its victims' deepest fears. Yet it rarely relies on this, instead opting to lie in wait, slowly eroding the minds of those who are unfortunate enough to cross it, driving them to madness. Victims often lose their grip on reality—and life—long before laying their eyes on a dreadcrow. If approached too closely, dreadcrows will retreat in darkness, snuffing any chance of seeing their true form, before assaulting the mind of their prey and plunging them into a smothering abyss of terror.



Dreadcrow

Medium aberration, chaotic evil

Armor Class 13 (18 with Illusory Horror)

Hit Points 84 (13d8 + 26)

Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	5 (-3)	12 (+1)	21 (+5)

Saving Throws Wis +4

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +9

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, frightened

Senses blindsight 120 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 17

Languages —

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Fear Smith. Creatures can't have advantage on saving throws against the dreadcrow's effects that cause the frightened condition. While a creature is frightened of the dreadcrow, the creature has disadvantage on Intelligence and Wisdom checks, as the creature's reality crumbles.

Innate Spellcasting. The dreadcrow's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 16). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material or verbal components:

3/day each: *blind ambush* [†], *fear*, *pass without trace*

1/day: *circle of death*

Illusory Horror. The dreadcrow's appearance is an illusion, reflecting the worst fear of the observer. It gains a bonus to its AC equal to its Charisma modifier while it isn't incapacitated.

In addition, when a creature that can see the dreadcrow starts its turn within 30 feet of it, the creature must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened. A creature that isn't surprised can avert its eyes at the start of its turn to avoid the saving throw at the start of its turn. If the creature does so, it can't see the dreadcrow until the start of the creature's next turn, when it can avert its eyes again. If the creature looks at the dreadcrow in the meantime, it must immediately make the saving throw. Creatures within 5 feet of the dreadcrow have advantage on this saving throw, as they partially see its true form.

Creatures seeing the dreadcrow with truesight ignore this trait's effects.

Magic Resistance. The Dreadcrow has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

The success that the once prosperous Luyarnha knew bred complacency and hubris, cardinal sins that no god would leave unpunished. Dreadcrows are said to be born of this divine retaliation, but in stark contrast to their supposed holy origins, dreadcrows are some of the most aberrant creatures to walk the realms. They terrorize, torture, and torment all, with a sinister preference for the defenseless—newborns or the elderly.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dreadcrow makes two attacks with its claws or Devour Fear. It can use Living Nightmare in place of one attack.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d12 + 3) slashing damage and 5 (1d10) psychic damage.

Devour Fear. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +8 to hit, range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 21 (3d10 + 5) psychic damage. If the target is frightened, the dreadcrow has advantage on the attack roll and regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

Flay Sanity (Recharge 5-6). The dreadcrow creates atrocious illusions that rend sanity. Each creature within 120 feet of it must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or gain a short-term madness and become frightened for 1 minute. Frightened creatures have disadvantage on this saving throw. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. This action doesn't reveal the dreadcrow if it's hidden.

Living Nightmare (Recharges after a Long Rest). The dreadcrow becomes the embodiment of terror for a creature that is frightened of it within 60 feet of it. This unleashes a primal fear within the target, causing the target to go insane. It must make a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target bellows a scream so powerful that it rips its own vocal cords and it loses the ability to speak. If the target is still frightened of the dreadcrow at the start of the dreadcrow's next turn and the target can see the dreadcrow, the terror becomes so untenable that it rips out its own eyes, becoming blinded.

BONUS ACTIONS

Gaze Upon Me. The dreadcrow forces a creature that it can see within 30 feet to look at it. The target must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom check or look directly at the Dreadcrow.

REACTIONS

Skittering Walk. When a creature moves within 5 feet of the Dreadcrow, the Dreadcrow can move up to 20 feet. Its AC increases by 3 during this movement.



NIGHTGAUNT

Nightgaunts are nightmarish beings, in the truest sense of the word. Originating from the demented slumber of a Great One, they are its will made manifest. Uncouth black things with smooth, oily, whale-like skin, unpleasant horns that curved inward toward each other, bat wings whose beating made no sound, ugly prehensile claws, and tails that lashed needlessly and disquietingly. They never speak or laugh, and never smile because they have no faces at all to smile with, only a maddening blankness where a face ought to be.

Nightgaunts are creatures that subsist on the raw emotions of their prey, lurking in the shadows as their victims writhe in the throes of vicious nightmares. They reveal themselves only when their hunger becomes unbearable, isolating unsuspecting individuals before tormenting them, releasing them only once they've had their fill. Nightgaunts don't take lives, nor inflict grievous physical wounds, unless attacked first. However, the mental scars they wreak are hard to heal, leaving many of their victims with bouts of insomnia and a fear of the dark that can last for a lifetime.

Nightgaunt

Large aberration, neutral

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)
Hit Points 110 (13d10 + 39)
Speed 20 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	21 (+5)	17 (+3)	4 (-3)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +8
Skills Athletics +6, Perception +6, Stealth +11
Damage Resistances psychic
Condition Immunities blinded
Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 16
Languages understands Deep Speech but can't speak
Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Blank Face. When a creature that can see the nightgaunt start its turn within 5 feet of the nightgaunt or enter that area for the first time on a turn, the creature must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened of the nightgaunt for 1 minute and gain a short-term madness. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the frightened condition ends for it, the creature is immune to the nightgaunt's Blank Face for the next 24 hours.

Flyby. The nightgaunt doesn't provoke opportunity attacks when it flies out of an enemy's reach.

Magic Resistance. The nightgaunt has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Silent Tormenter. The nightgaunt makes no sound, ever. It has advantage on Stealth checks and is automatically hidden from creatures that can't see it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The nightgaunt makes two claw attacks and uses its Tail.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage. If the target is a Medium or smaller creature, it is grappled (escape DC 16). The nightgaunt has two claws, each of which can grapple only one target. Until this grapple ends, the nightgaunt can't use that claw to attack any other creature.

Tail. The nightgaunt uses its tail in one of the following ways.

Tail Whip. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (4d4 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Prehensile Tail. The nightgaunt flails its tail towards a creature that it can see within 10 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 16 Constitution saving throw or be overwhelmed by the pain and be incapacitated until the start of the nightgaunt's next turn. If the saving throw fails by 5 or more, the target is instead stunned until the start of the nightgaunt's next turn, as it loses control of its body. Creatures that have a speed of 0 have disadvantage on this saving throw.

BONUS ACTIONS

Night Rush. The nightgaunt moves up to half its flying speed.

REACTIONS

Feed on Emotions. When a creature within 10 feet of the nightgaunt fails a saving throw against its Blank Face or Prehensile Tail, the nightgaunt can feed on the creature's emotions—fear, anger, surprise—and regains 8 (1d10 + 3) hit points. If a creature fails the saving throw by 5 or more, the nightgaunt regains 14 (2d10 + 3) hit points instead.



CLOISTERED MAIDEN

Before the Scourge, before even the First War, the hubris of wizards invited the eldritch powers to assert their will. These osteomancers, magicians who delve into the magic of bones, sought to enhance their own bodies—growing to the heights of giants, making armour of bony plates, and forming blades from calcified protrusions. Like moths to a flame, eldritch beings were drawn to these spellcasters and corrupted their magic, resulting in the malformed creatures known as cloistered maidens.

Sexual Dimorphism

Over a few days, a period known as the Great Unchaining, all who practiced osteomancy lost control of their spells. All male osteomancers began dying, their bones growing in warped, fractal patterns and piercing their own organs. Their female counterparts fared even worse: borne by a flood of necromantic magic, their bodies grew into large, twisted creatures, vessels for the eldritch powers that overcame them.

Eternal Hunger

These half-dead corpses feel nothing more than an insatiable hunger that drives them to devour anything alive. Indeed, reports of a cloistered maiden are often the first priority for hunters lest they turn entire neighbourhoods into corpse and bone. The Radiant Church, ever vocal in its disparagement of osteomancy, proclaims these maidens to be manifestations of the sin of gluttony, another instrument in the toolbox of propaganda they use to sway the populace.

Cloistered Maiden

Large aberration & undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points 133 (14d10 + 56)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	10 (+0)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +3

Skills Arcana +5, Deception +6, Perception +3, Stealth +6

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Damage Immunities necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Deep Speech

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Sharp Fangs. The maiden has advantage on attack rolls against creatures it is grappling.

Innate Spellcasting. The maiden's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *alter self*, *chill touch* (2d8)

3/day: *animate dead* (up to five skeletons)

Bone Regeneration. The maiden regains 10 hit points and reforms any of its broken bones at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point.

Magic Strikes. The maiden's attacks are magical.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The maiden makes two attacks: one with its bite and one with its claw. It can use Feast instead of its bite.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.

Hit: 18 (2d12 + 5) piercing damage. If the target is a Huge or smaller creature, it is grappled (escape DC 16). Until this grapple ends, the maiden can't bite another target.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target.

Hit: 16 (2d10 + 5) slashing damage.

Feast. The maiden makes one bite attack against a Medium or smaller creature it is grappling. If the attack hits, the target takes the bite's damage, the target is devoured, and the grapple ends. While devoured, the creature is restrained, it has total cover against attacks and other effects outside the maiden, and it takes 20 (8d4) piercing damage at the start of each of the maiden's turns. The maiden can only have one creature devoured at a time.

If the maiden takes 20 damage or more on a single turn from a creature inside it, its teeth break and the creature inside of it falls prone in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the maiden. If the maiden dies, a swallowed creature is no longer restrained by it and can escape from the corpse by using 10 feet of movement, exiting prone.

Spinal Explosion (1/Day). The maiden releases all the bony protrusions on its spine. Each creature within 30 feet of the maiden must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 28 (8d6) piercing damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one. Each creature that fails the saving throw is also embedded with bony spikes. At the start of the creature's next turn, it must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, it becomes restrained, as its body begins to harden. On a successful save, its body ejects the spikes and it isn't otherwise affected.

A restrained creature must make another DC 14 Constitution saving throw at the start of its next turn. On a success, the effect ends on the creature. On a failure, its skin hardens into bone and it becomes petrified until the maiden dies, or until it is released by a *greater restoration* spell.

CHAINED GIANT

Deep within the subterranean depths of the Asylum, a network of chambers houses a once-proud race of giants, now transformed into grotesque monstrosities through years of barbaric experimentation.

Prisoners of War. The First War saw Luyarnha pitted against its expansionist enemies, driving the city-state to abandon all moral principles in its quest for means to combat the rampant scourge that threatened its citizens. The early scholars of death, dogged in their determination, pressed forward with their grotesque experiments, and in their desperate pursuit of the perfect hunter, recognized the frailty of the humanoid body. They turned to capturing and subduing giants for their grim work—beings that could withstand more suffering before death.

Derelict Patients. To ensure the subjects' cooperation and restrict their movements during harrowing procedures, the giants were chained with bonds that burrowed deep into their very bones. Heavy armor was then affixed to their twisted forms, before injecting them with refined cerebro-spinal fluid extracted from Otherworldly beings, twisting their bodies and shattering their minds. Their usefulness was eventually outlived, as the scholars, now enlightened, resumed their experiments on humanoids. With the giants' blood now corrosive and their minds destroyed, they remain imprisoned in their bleak chambers, abandoned, condemned to pain and insanity until their eventual death, forgotten by all.

Chained Giant

Huge giant, chaotic evil

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 149 (13d12 + 65)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	15 (+2)	20 (+5)	7 (-2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Dex +5, Con +8, Wis +4

Skills Athletics +12, Perception +4

Damage Resistances fire

Damage Immunities necrotic

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Giant

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Accursed Blood. At the end of the giant's turns, if it has fewer than half its hit point maximum, each creature within 10 feet of it takes 13 (3d8) necrotic damage, unless the giant has taken radiant damage since the end of its last turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The giant uses its Sweep Chains and then makes two fist attacks.

Fist. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (3d4 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

Rock. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, range 60/240 ft., one target. *Hit:* 28 (4d10 + 6) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Sweep Chains. The giant swings its chains, forcing each creature within 20 feet of it must make a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed saving throw, a creature takes 15 (2d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage and is knocked prone.

BONUS ACTIONS

Stomp. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one prone target. *Hit:* 13 (3d4 + 6) bludgeoning damage and the target must make a DC 17 Constitution saving throw. On a failure the target is staggered for 1 minute. A staggered creature suffers a 1d8 penalty on attack rolls, ability checks, and Strength and Dexterity saving throws. The staggered target repeats the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

REACTIONS

Lead Catching. If a rock, cannonball, or similar object is hurled at the giant, the giant can make a DC 10 Dexterity saving throw, catching the missile and taking no damage from it on a success.



HOLLOW SENTINEL

The Hollow Sentinels, an elite sect within the Grey Templars of the Radiant Order, were created to hunt not beasts but men—the osteomancers. These tireless inquisitors have undergone a gruesome transmutation, rendering them immune to the corrupting magic of these blasphemous wizards.

In a secret rite known only in the highest echelons of the Grey Templars, the bones of these chosen few are meticulously removed and replaced with an advanced composite, bestowed by the Scions and transmuted into a divine element through days of fervent prayers and blessings. This miraculous metamorphosis imbues the Hollow Sentinels with unparalleled resilience, enabling them to ignore even the most potent osteomantic spells.

The process of becoming a Hollow Sentinel is not without risk, and only the most devoted and resolute candidates are chosen to undergo the transformation. The loss of their innate skeletal framework is an excruciating ordeal; nevertheless, the Sentinels maintain that there is no nobler sacrifice than the ones they render in the name of their righteous duty. Albeit, the toll exacted for the attainment of such might is a remarkably slow recovery—borne from the partial loss of their humanity—oftentimes necessitating days to heal from a single mission, thereby constraining the church's capacity to deploy these invaluable combatants.



Hollow Sentinel

Medium construct & humanoid, lawful good

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 110 (13d8 + 52)

Speed 40 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	17 (+3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Con +7, Wis +6

Skills Arcana +5, Athletics +7, Insight +9, Perception +6

Damage Resistances poison, psychic

Damage Immunities necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from magical attacks

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages Common, Orc, understands Deep Speech but doesn't speak it

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Iron Will. The Sentinel has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, and magic can't put the Sentinel to sleep.

Mithral Bones. The Sentinel doesn't have bones.

Silvered Weapons. The Sentinel's weapon attacks are silvered.

Mage Breaker. When the Sentinel damages a creature that is concentrating on a spell, the DC for the saving throw the target makes to maintain its concentration is increased by 7 (minimum 17). In addition, the Sentinel has advantage on saving throws against spells cast by creatures within 5 feet of it.

Immutable Form. The Sentinel is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Innate Spellcasting. The Sentinel's innate spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 14). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *detect good and evil*, *detect magic*, *disguise self*, *identify*

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Sentinel makes four blade attacks.

Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d12 + 4) slashing damage and 4 (1d8) radiant damage.

Mithral Wind Strike (1/Day). The Sentinel chooses up to three creatures it can see within 30 feet of it and makes a melee spell attack (+6 to hit) against each target. On a hit, a target takes 19 (3d12) slashing damage and 13 (3d8) radiant damage. It can then teleport to an unoccupied space it can see within 5 feet of one of the targets. The Sentinel regains the use of this action if a creature within 30 feet of it loses concentration on a spell.

BONUS ACTIONS

Breaking Palm. The Sentinel touches a creature within 5 feet of it, removing any temporary hit points the target has.

Dash. The Sentinel takes the Dash action.

REACTIONS

Parry. The Sentinel adds 3 to its AC against one melee attack that would hit it. To do so, the Sentinel must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

Anti-Magic Strike. When a creature within 5 feet of the Sentinel casts a spell, the Sentinel can make a melee weapon attack against it.

JAEGER

The jaegers of Luyarnha stand as the city's premier line of defense, a formidable force whose might single-handedly turned the tides of battle in the First War. These warriors exhibit an unwavering commitment to their city, always the first to answer the call of duty and often the last thing their adversaries see. In their hands, the jaegers wield potent trick weapons gifted to them by the Church and other factions dedicated to the city's salvation. With these instruments of destruction, they can decimate entire squadrons of beasts and humanoids, nimbly evading attacks and relentlessly pursuing their quarry until their blades sink into their targets.

The mysterious process of their creation is closely guarded by their creators, the enigmatic Obitus Scholare. With the ongoing city lockdown, however, the ranks of the jaegers have been gradually thinning. They fall in battle more rapidly than new jaegers can be forged. It is the hope of all citizens that Luyarnha can stem the tide of the Scourge before their mightiest shield shatters.

Every jaeger's life revolves around a strict regimen of training and battle, honing their skills and reflexes beyond the potential of mere mortals: with each kill, they sharpen their instincts, bolstering their own strength and becoming harder to kill—an unfortunate truth that applies even to those of them who lose their sanity. Jaegers are the city's greatest hope and the embodiment of its deepest fear—the jaegers, ever the hunters, ever the hunted.



Jaeger

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 18 (natural armor)
Hit Points 123 (19d8 + 38)
Speed 45 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	19 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Dex +7, Int +5

Skills Athletics +6, Perception +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages any one language (usually Common)

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Encircling Strikes. Once per turn, when the jaeger attacks from the opposite side of a creature from where it started its turn, or attacks while on the opposite side of a creature from an ally, it deals an additional 3 (1d6) damage on a hit.

Evasion. If the jaeger is subjected to an effect that allows it to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, the jaeger instead takes no damage if it succeeds on the saving throw, and only half damage if it fails.

Flexible Combatant. When the jaeger draws or stows a weapon, it can draw or stow another weapon with the other hand. It can reload weapons with the loading, reload, or barrel properties without a free hand.

Additionally, if the jaeger is carrying a one-handed melee weapon in one hand, and a one-handed ranged weapon in the other hand, it doesn't have disadvantage on attack rolls with ranged weapons from being within 5 feet of a hostile creature.

Hemorrhaging Wound (Recharge 5-6). The jaeger can't use this trait on the first round of combat. When the jaeger hits a creature with a blade attack, it rends a vicious wound. At the end of each of the target's turns, it loses 17 (5d6) hit points. Each time the target takes damage from this effect, the number of dice of damage it takes at the end of its next turn is reduced by one, and the bleeding stops when the number of dice is reduced to 0. A bleeding creature can make a Constitution saving throw at the end of each of its turns, after taking the damage, ending the effect on a success. The DC equals 15 + half the number of dice of damage remaining (rounded down).

If the jaeger hits a bleeding target with a blade attack, the target doesn't gain a new wound, but its wound's damage resets to 5d6.

Magic Weapons. The jaeger's weapon attacks are magical.

Piercing Gaze (1/Day). The jaeger gains darkvision out to 120 feet and the effect of *see invisibility* for 1 hour (no action required).

Sharp Senses. Whenever the jaeger uses its **Dodge Step**, **Weapon Parry**, or **Chasing Finisher**, it gains advantage on its next attack roll.

Special Equipment. The jaeger wields a *dream executioner*. Alternatively it can be wielding an *orphan's cradle*, a *serpent bladewhip*, or a *meat hookshot*. Its blade attack and references to it are replaced with an attack made with the respective weapon.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The jaeger makes three blade attacks. If it is wielding a firearm, it can also make one firearm attack.

Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) slashing damage.

Firearm. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 60/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Chasing Finisher (Recharge 5-6). The jaeger moves 40 feet and makes a blade attack. On a hit, the target takes an additional 14 (4d6) slashing damage.

REACTIONS

Dodge Step (3/Short Rest). When a creature the jaeger can see attacks it, if its speed isn't 0, it moves up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks and makes a Dexterity saving throw with a DC equal to the attack roll's result. On a success, it evades completely and the attack misses. On a failure, it takes only half damage if the attack hits.

Weapon Parry (3/Short Rest). The jaeger fires off a bullet to deflect an attack that it can see within 60 feet of it. To do so, the jaeger must be wielding a firearm. It reduces the attack's damage by 13 (1d10 + 8). If this reduces the damage to 0, the attacker is stunned until the start of its next turn, as the bullet hits a nervous junction.

LUNAR REVENANT

The inexplicable feeling of fear that grips the heart and wrenches the gut is not a rare occurrence in Luyarnha. Most citizens blame that fear on the horrors that lurk in the streets at night, but some of the town's most deranged denizens accuse an unseen force: skeletal behemoths that lie in wait atop the spires of the city, and alongside its walls.

Silent Watchers

Lunar revenants move unseen, their form only revealed by the light of the moon, dwelling in locales where the stench of death permeates the very air they breathe. Hence, it comes as no surprise that so many are drawn to Luyarnha and its murderous madness. These eerie creatures do not make a sound, even upon death, they simply vanish, leaving behind naught but a thin trail of ash, the sole memento of their existence.

Peaceful Brutality

Although they never initiate a battle, once provoked, Lunar revenants become brutal engines of death, relentlessly attacking until their opponents lie shattered, before returning to their idle occupations, as if the fight was but a mere bad dream. Few hunters can testify to their ruthlessness, as few ever made it out alive. The first attack against a lunar revenant was ordered by the Radiant Church, in a misguided attempt to quell the tale of their existence. That night, dozens of hunters perished to bring down a single revenant, a sacrifice none were ready to pay. Thereafter, it was decided that these beings were best left well alone; after all, it is much easier to silence those who would spread rumors.

We don't know where they came from, nor what they desire, but we have learned through bloodshed that they are best left well alone.

Lunar Revenant

Huge undead, lawful neutral

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points 136 (13d12 + 52)

Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	10 (+0)	18 (+4)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws Dex +3, Con +7

Skills Stealth +3

Damage Resistances cold, necrotic; piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages -

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Fear Aura. Any creature that starts its turn within 120 feet of the revenant must make a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is frightened until the start of its next turn. If a creature's saving throw is successful, the creature is immune to the revenant's Fear Aura for the next 24 hours. If a creature cannot see the revenant, it automatically fails the saving throw.

Lunar Invisibility. While not in moonlight, the revenant is invisible and incapacitated.

Magic Resistance. The revenant has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons. The revenant's attacks are magical.

Spider Climb. The revenant can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The revenant makes three attacks: two slams and one with its greatsword.

Greatsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 27 (6d6 + 6) slashing damage.

Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (3d6 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

Teleport. The revenant magically teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 120 feet to an unoccupied space it can see that is illuminated by moonlight.

Maddening Screech (Recharge 5-6). The revenant howls an inaudible sound that shatters the mind. Each creature within 60 feet of the revenant must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw, taking 33 (6d10) psychic damage and gaining one short-term madness on a failure.



Roaring Mane

Large beast & elemental, unaligned

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 110 (13d10 + 39)

Speed 50 ft., burrow 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)	3 (-4)	13 (+1)	7 (-2)

Saving Throws Dex +5

Skills Athletics +7

Damage Vulnerabilities thunder

Damage Resistances poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities exhaustion, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages understands Primordial but can't speak

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Dune Predator. Whenever the roaring mane damages a prone creature with an attack, the creature's AC is reduced by 1 until the end of its next turn.

Earthen Pounce. If the roaring mane moves at least 15 feet underground or straight toward a target and then hits it with a claw attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 9 (2d8) slashing damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone. If the target is prone, the roaring mane can make a bite attack against it as a bonus action.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The roaring mane has advantage on Perception checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Unwavering Pride. The roaring mane has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The roaring mane makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) piercing damage.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage.

Tectonic Roar (Recharge 6). The roaring mane unleashes an earth-shattering roar, sending out a shockwave in a 15-foot cone in front of it. Each creature within the area must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or take 22 (4d10) thunder damage, be knocked prone, and have its speed reduced to 0 until the end of its next turn.

The roaring mane can use this action while it is burrowed, and if it does so, the ground in the area becomes difficult terrain for other creatures for 1 minute. Each 5-foot square of difficult terrain can be cleared if a creature spends its action to do so.

ROARING MANE

The advent of the First War brought forth unanticipated terrors from the southern reaches, among them were the roaring manes, elemental lions that can tunnel through earth and explode onto the battlefield with deafening roars that unnerve even the most seasoned warriors. The precise method employed by the southern armies to tame these fierce beasts remains a mystery, with captured soldiers cryptically alluding to sharing a bond of blood.

These beasts, once capable of burrowing beneath the Luyarnha's primitive walls, never could penetrate stone nor steel. Ironically, the menace they once posed bolstered the city's defenses, providing employment opportunities for the cursed-bloods, who went on to strengthen not only the city walls but also the city's infrastructure. This construction effort thwarted roaring manes, the reinforced ramparts now more profound and impervious—a fortified blend that would serve to break their claws.

In the era before ramparts and the Scions' mastery over lightning and thunder, roaring manes were a dreadful omen on the battlefield. However, today, with the resolution of the First War, the echoes of the roaring manes' destructive past have vanished and the few that remain are held in captivity, serving as amusement for the city's nobility in their combat arenas.



BLUE-FLAME CUSTODIAN

Creations of the Scions, blue-flame custodians are instrumental tools of the eldritch hunt, as their azure flames reveal even those who lurk beyond. Though their minds are engineered to be unbreakable, their swords often fail under the tremendous force of their blows. The cerulean fire that powers them is manufactured by exposing flames to Scionic lightning, a practice that some in their ranks call blasphemous.

A custodian's sturdy body is used as a shield in the midst of battle, defending the intellectual and frail scientists that are the Scions—a shield that must be held separate from one's body. Indeed, some have tried to create armor from the body of custodians; all were immolated by the azure flames.

In the aftermath of the first hunts, the production of blue-flame custodians came to a halt, as the rare metals required for their construction disappeared, along with entire trade routes, when Luyarnha was cut off from the world. Now, what remains of these living suits of armor is fiercely protected by the Scions, and their bodies are always sought after, should they fall in battle.



Blue-Flame Custodian

Large construct, unaligned

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points 168 (16d10 + 80)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	9 (-1)	20 (+5)	3 (-4)	11 (+0)	1 (-5)

Damage Resistances piercing

Damage Immunities fire, poison, psychic

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, invisible, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands the languages of its creator but can't speak

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP)

Illumination. The custodian sheds bright light in a 10-foot radius and dim light for an additional 10 feet.

Immutable Form. The custodian is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Inferno (1/Day). Upon approaching death's door, the custodian unleashes its full potential. When the custodian is reduced to 84 hit points or fewer, its flames consume it for the next minute, and it gains the following benefits:

- At the start of each of its turns, each creature within 5 feet of it takes 5 (2d4) fire damage.
- Its Blue-Flame Blast creates a 30-foot cone and deals an additional 3 (1d6) fire damage.
- Its melee weapon attacks deal an additional 2 (1d4) fire damage on a hit.
- Its speed is doubled.

Magic Resistance. The custodian has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons. The custodian's weapon attacks are magical.

Scorching Azure. Whenever the custodian deals fire damage, its blue flames are unleashed. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or be scorched by them for 1 minute or until a creature takes an action to douse the fire. While scorched in this way, a creature sheds dim light in a 10-foot radius, takes 2 (1d4) fire damage at the start of each of its turns, can't benefit from being invisible, and the custodian can see it through full cover while within 300 feet of it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The custodian makes two melee attacks.

Sword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (3d8 + 4) slashing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Blue-Flame Burst. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d10) fire damage.

Blue-Flame Blast (Recharge 3-6). The custodian magically releases a blast of flames in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in that area must make a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw, taking 14 (4d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. A creature within 5 feet of the custodian can use its reaction to attempt to redirect the flames before creatures make their saving throws. It must make a contested Athletics check. On a success, it can choose in which direction the custodian releases the burst of flames.

REACTIONS

Blinding Nova. When the custodian is attacked by a creature within 30 feet of it that it can see, the custodian can impose disadvantage on the attack roll, causing a burst of blinding flames to erupt from itself. An attacker that can't be blinded is immune to this effect.



CERVUS TENEBRIS

The cervus tenebris, spectral beings adorned with massive sets of ghostly wings, prowl the shadows in search of their next unsuspecting victim. Once humanoid, they were driven by an insatiable hunger so monstrous that they succumbed to the unthinkable act of cannibalism. In the throes of their grisly feast, they consumed their own bodies, an abomination that should have led to their demise. But the cosmos had other plans. Instead of meeting their end, they underwent a heinous transformation, becoming monstrous beings shrouded in shadows and damned to a never-ending existence of torment.

Only while it hunts does the gnawing pain that crucifies its body dull—it lives in a constant state of agony. This torment it externalizes unto its victims, summoning shadows from the fallen to stalk and drain the life from its quarries, weakening them for an inevitable, gruesome death. The cervus tenebris hunts by consuming the flesh and shadows of the living, growing more formidable as it feasts upon the essence of its prey, its spectral wings expanding as it gorges itself upon the life of its victims.

Cervus Tenebris

Medium monstrosity, neutral evil

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 105 (14d8 + 42)

Speed 30 ft., fly 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	21 (+5)	17 (+3)	3 (-4)	16 (+3)	19 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +9, Wis +7

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +9

Damage Resistances acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moon-gilded

Damage Immunities necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, grappled, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained, stunned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages —

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The tenebris can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Intangible Body. The tenebris's body is made of moving shadows; ranged weapon attacks against it are made with disadvantage.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the tenebris has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Perception checks that rely on sight.

Vile Aura. Beasts refuse to approach closer than 30 feet of the tenebris. If a beast ends its turn in that area, it must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 1 minute.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The tenebris makes two attacks.

Cannibalize. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 27 (5d8 + 5) piercing damage. The target must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken and the tenebris regains half as many hit points and one use of its Shadow Jump. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Jump (2/Day). The tenebris teleports to a space in darkness that it can see within 60 feet of it. Alternatively, it teleports inside of the space of a Medium or larger creature within 60 feet of it, emerging from the creature's entrails.

Create Shadows. The tenebris targets the corpse of a humanoid within 10 feet of it that died violently in the last hour. The target's spirit rises as a shadow in its space and the corpse can't be targeted in this way again. This shadow is under the tenebris's control. The tenebris can have no more than two shadows under its control at a time.

REACTIONS

Feast on Darkness. When the tenebris reduces a creature to 0 hit points, it devours the creature's shadow. The tenebris's wings grow longer; its flying speed increases by 20 feet, and it gains a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls for 1 minute or until it falls unconscious. It can gain this bonus multiple times, each time it devours a creature's shadow. A creature whose shadow has been devoured can't be targeted by this reaction again. A remove curse spell cast on a creature that lost its shadow allows it to regrow it.

DEVOURING BELUA

The emergence of such a formidable monster as this breed of belua is a rare and dreaded event. Most beluas succumb to their curse and transform into lesser monstrosities, such as the Scourge Lycans, which though still dangerous, don't possess the same unfathomable savagery as their greater kin. However, should a particularly skilled hunter lose their grip on their own humanity, they may become a far greater menace to the city than any mere beast they had once vanquished.

The devouring belua is a fearsome monstrosity birthed from the unbridled fury of an eponymous scourgeborne, a monster that bears witness to the brutal nature of their curse. Once half-beasts of lupine visage, with a tenuous hold on their souls, they are now consumed by the inferno of their own anger, and have surrendered entirely to their bestial essence, abandoning any semblance of morality. The devouring belua's lupine form has completely overtaken their humanoid shape; their once unblemished skin now a mangled tangle of coarse, matted hair; their muzzles elongated, filled with razor-sharp teeth that rend flesh with vicious ease; and their howls, harrowing echoes of their suffering, are now cacophonous cries that freeze the blood of those who hear them.

Once turned, these monsters prowl the shadowed alleyways and desolate corners of Luyarnha, their blind anger robbing them of their sight, like a cruel poetry of fate. Relying solely on their heightened senses of hearing and smell to navigate the world around them, their blindness now only serves as a catalyst for their rage, ensuring that anyone—beast or human—who crosses their path will be met with a storm of ferocity.

It is whispered that devouring belua are capable of detecting the rage that lies dormant in the hearts of others, drawn to the turmoil that festers within. They prey upon these enraged souls, devouring the very essence of their anger, leaving behind a broken husk, devoid of fury or flesh, whilst feeding their own insatiable anger in vain.



Devouring Belua

Large monstrosity, chaotic evil

Armor Class 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points 123 (13d10 + 52)

Speed 50 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	18 (+4)	19 (+4)	3 (-4)	17 (+3)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws Con +8

Skills Athletics +9, Perception +11

Damage Resistance bludgeoning, piercing, slashing

Condition Immunities blinded

Senses blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 21

Languages —

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP)

Blood Frenzy. The belua has advantage on melee attack rolls against any creature that doesn't have all its hit points.

Crippling Strikes. Creatures provoke opportunity attacks from the belua even if they take the Disengage action before leaving its reach. When the belua hits a creature with an opportunity attack, the creature's speed becomes 0 for the rest of the turn.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The belua has advantage on Perception checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Never-ending Fury. The belua has advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws and a +3 bonus to its damage for melee weapon attacks (included in the attacks).

Regeneration. The belua regains 15 hit points at the start of its turn. If the belua takes damage from a moongilded weapon, this trait doesn't function at the start of the belua's next turn. The Belua dies only if it starts its turn with 0 hit points and doesn't regenerate.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The belua makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (2d8 + 8) piercing damage. This attack scores a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20 on the d20. On a critical hit, the belua's monstrous jaws rip off one of the target's appendages. Roll a d12 on the following table for the result:

1-2: Right forearm

3-4: Left forearm

5-6: Right hand

7-8: Left hand

9: Left leg

10: Right leg

11: Gut

12: Head

A creature that has an appendage ripped off takes 5 (1d10) necrotic damage at the start of each of its turns as it bleeds out, until it receives magical healing. If its gut is ripped off, it takes 11 (2d10) necrotic damage instead. A creature that loses its head dies if it can't live without it.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d4 + 8) slashing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Bestial Rage (3/Day). The belua enters a feral rage fuelled by its ravenous hunger. It becomes Huge, it gains 20 temporary hit points, and the number of damage dice of its natural weapon attacks increase by one (3d8 for the bite and 3d4 for the claw). This transformation lasts for 1 minute, or until the belua takes more than 15 damage from a moongilded weapon in a single turn, or until the belua dies.

Leap. The belua jumps up to 50 feet horizontally or vertically.

VARIANT: REVELATIONS

Some unfortunate beluas cross path with accursed weapons that robs them of their sight, hastening the scourgeborne's descent into their fully transformed, Devouring kin. Such a belua has a CR of 11, and gains the following trait:

Special Equipment. The Devouring Belua has a **Revelations** (SGtEH page 248). It can replace its claw attacks with attacks with the weapon.

Owlbear

Huge monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)
Hit Points 184 (16d12 + 80)
Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	15 (+2)	20 (+5)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	7 (-2)

Saving Throws Con +9, Wis +5

Skills Perception +9, Stealth +6

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, poison

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages -

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP)

Keen Sight and Smell. The owlbear has advantage on Perception checks that rely on sight or smell.

Regeneration. The owlbear regains 15 hit points at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point. If any of its limbs are severed (including tentacle or head), they instead regrow and the owlbear doesn't regain hit points.

Fear of Radiance. If the owlbear takes radiant damage, it suffers a -2 penalty to its AC and Dexterity saving throws until the end of its next turn and becomes enraged. While enraged, the owlbear attacks the source of the radiant damage until the target dies, it has advantage on attack rolls against it. Once the owlbear becomes enraged, for the next minute, it continues to attack this target until it or the target dies.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The owlbear makes three attacks: two with its tentacles and one with its beak or fanged neck.

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (3d10 + 6) piercing damage.

Fanged Neck. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (3d6 + 6) piercing damage. If the target is grappled by the owlbear, the attack is a critical hit.

Tentacle. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 20 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (3d8 + 6) piercing damage, and the target must make a DC 18 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, the target is impaled by the tentacle and is grappled (Escape DC 18) and restrained while grappled in this way. A tentacle can be cut down, freeing any impaled creatures. The tentacle has the same damage resistances as the owlbear, AC 16, and 20 hit points. Any damage dealt to the tentacle is also dealt to the owlbear, up to a maximum of 20. The Owlbear has two tentacles and can only make a tentacle attack or grapple with tentacles that haven't been cut down.

BONUS ACTIONS

Rush. The Owlbear moves up to half its speed.

The owlbear, an eldritch abomination of feather, fur, and flesh, is a grotesque chimera that defies all reason and order. With the head of an owl, the body of a bear, and the scales of a serpent, it moves with an unnatural, fluid grace, as if its bones were made of rubber rather than calcium. Its matted fur is a patchwork of grays and browns, covered in a sickly sheen of slime and sweat, and its twisted tentacles are incapable of swimming, instead serving as a mockery of the octopus form.

The neck of an owlbear is the most unsettling aspect of its monstrous form. Adorned with a swirling mass of fleshy fangs, its neck is a kaleidoscope of madness that seems to shift and writhe of its own accord. As an owlbear approaches, the stench of decay and corruption precedes it, filling the air with a noxious cloud of rot and filth. Its jaws, lined with razor-sharp teeth, click and snap with a rhythmic hunger that speaks of its insatiable appetite for flesh. Its claws, long and curved like sickles, are stained with the blood of countless victims, and its very presence seems to warp reality around it, plunging the world into a nightmare of darkness and chaos where light will be snuffed out.





PENITENT

Librarian Kristoff's Journal Entry #32 – The Penitent

This plane does not birth them, yet they feast on the limbs of its denizens. Could they be aberrations born from the Scourge's corruption upon our citizenry? I find it improbable, given their uniform golden masks – an oddity unlikely from simple mutation. Perhaps remnants of church weaponry of the First War?

That too seems a stretch. The sacred tomes affixed to their sides bear no resemblance to any religious texts I have encountered. An important piece of the puzzle that deepens the mystery surrounding them.

One particularly unsettling observation – they possess a capability akin to 'reproduction.' Yet, instead of a natural birthing process, they seem to corrupt other beings into their likeness, each new convert subsequently donning a similar golden mask.

They abhor sunlight and shun noise, fleeing from both like beasts before a flame. This would explain why they rarely appear above the surface. My studies lead me to speculate on the existence of an overarching hive mind, a singular consciousness puppeteering these drones.

Penitent

Large humanoid & monstrosity, chaotic evil

Armor Class 12
Hit Points 247 (26d10 + 104)
Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
25 (+7)	15 (+2)	19 (+4)	3 (-4)	13 (+1)	19 (+4)

Saving Throws Con +8

Skills Acrobatics +6, Athletics +11

Condition Immunities exhaustion, frightened

Senses blindsight 120 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 11

Languages —

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP)

Accursed Body. The penitent's body is barely held together. Whenever the penitent takes more than 50 damage, one of its limbs disintegrates into ash (each of its two arms first, then each of its two legs). If the penitent reattaches a lost limb, even if it belonged to a different humanoid, it regains 50 hit points.

Cleaving Strikes. When the penitent makes a melee weapon attack, it can make another attack with the same weapon against another creature within 5 feet of the original target and within reach as part of the same attack. If the penitent does so, its speed is halved until the end of its turn.

Magic Weapons. The penitent's weapon attacks are magical.

Mask of Penitence. While wearing its mask, the penitent is blinded and immune to madness.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The penitent makes three greatsword attacks. It can use Hands of Punishment in place of one attack.

Greatsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 21 (4d6 + 7) slashing damage.

Hands of Punishment. The penitent destroys one of the limbs in its crucible to summon blasphemous hands. Each creature in a 20-foot-radius sphere centered on a point that the penitent can see within 60 feet of it must succeed on a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw or take 2 (1d4) psychic damage and be restrained by the hands until the end of the penitent's next turn. While restrained in this way, corruption seeps within the target and it has disadvantage on Intelligence checks and Intelligence saving throws.

BONUS ACTIONS

Bloodthirsty Dash. The penitent moves up to its speed towards a hostile creature it can see without provoking opportunity attacks.

Limb Offering. The penitent warps the intellect of a creature it can see within 30 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 16 Intelligence saving throw or extend one of its limbs forward (the penitent's choice). If the penitent hits the target with a greatsword attack before the end of its turn, the limb is cut clean (see 'Losing Limbs', page 309 of SGtEH). The penitent then adds the limb to its crucible.

Reattach Limb (3/Day). The penitent magically attaches one of the limbs in its crucible to itself or a willing creature within its reach if that creature is missing the limb. The limb is fully functional, and the creature regains any abilities it lost due to the limb being severed. The penitent starts with 1d4 limbs in its crucible.

REACTIONS

Blasphemous Prison. When a creature starts its turn within 5 feet of the penitent, or enters the area for the first time on a turn, the penitent can entrap it in its crucible. The target must succeed on a DC 19 Dexterity saving throw or be trapped in the crucible. While trapped, the target is restrained, has total cover against effects outside the crucible, and takes 7 (2d6) fire damage at the start of each of the penitent's turns. A trapped creature, or an ally within reach, can use its action to make a DC 19 Athletics check, toppling the crucible and freeing the creature on a success.

If toppled, the crucible magically teleports onto the back of the penitent at the end of its next turn. Alternatively, the penitent can recall it as a bonus action. While not carrying the crucible, the penitent can't use its Hands of Punishment, Limb Offering, or Reattach Limb actions.



Galvanized Prowler

Large beast & monstrosity, chaotic evil

Armor Class 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points 152 (16d10 + 64)

Speed 40 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	19 (+4)	19 (+4)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	9 (-1)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Con +8

Skills Perception +5, Survival +5

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities lightning

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages —

Challenge 11 (7,200 XP)

Magic Weapons. The prowler's weapon attacks are magical.

Lightning Absorption. Whenever the prowler is subjected to lightning damage, it takes no damage. Instead, it regains hit points equal to half the damage dealt and can teleport up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space it can see and make one claw attack.

Lightning Reflexes. The prowler always takes its turn first in initiative order.

BONUS ACTIONS

Rampage. If the prowler reduced a creature to 0 hit points with a melee attack this turn, it moves up to half its speed and make a claw attack.

Call of the Storm (1/Day). The prowler howls as a bonus action, summoning a storm cloud above itself that it can direct, as per the *call lightning* spell (DC 16). In addition, it can use a bonus action on each of its turns while concentrating on the spell to target itself with a bolt of lightning.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The prowler makes two attacks: one with its bite and one with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.

Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) lightning damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.

Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) lightning damage.

Lightning Nova (Recharge 5-6). The prowler unleashes electricity with an explosive scream. Each creature within 20 feet of the prowler must make a DC 16 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 28 (8d6) lightning damage and can't use reactions or bonus actions until the end of the prowler's next turn. On a successful save, a creature takes half as much damage and suffers no additional effects. A creature that fails this save by 5 or more is also stunned until the end of the prowler's next turn.

REACTIONS

Thunderous Revival (1/Day). When the prowler is reduced to 0 hit points, it emits a thunderous howl, instantly regaining 33 (6d10) hit points. Each creature within 10 feet of the prowler must make a DC 16 Constitution saving throw, taking 16 (3d10) thunder damage and being knock prone on a failed saving throw, or taking half as much damage and not being knock prone on a successful one. A creature that fails this save by 5 or more is also stunned until the end of the prowler's next turn.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The prowler can take 1 legendary action, choosing the option below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The prowler regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Leap. The prowler jumps a number of feet up to its speed and lands on its feet in a space that can contain one or more other creatures. Each of those creatures must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage and 14 (4d6) lightning damage and is knocked prone. On a successful save, a creature takes half as much damage, isn't knocked prone, and is pushed 5 feet into an unoccupied space of the creature's choice. If no unoccupied space is within range, the creature instead falls prone in the prowler's space.

GALVANIZED PROWLER

A chimeric creation of beasts and bones, galvanized prowlers were once the epitome of Scion technology, a defensive bastion against the Scourge's onslaught. Corrupted by the eldritch components from which they were crafted, they slaughtered their masters and joined the ranks of those they once hunted.

Storm Hunter. Leaping between rooftops, galvanized prowlers are as avid storm chasers as they are predators; they revel in the refreshing tickle of a lightning strike on their skin and use a tempest's rolling thunder as cover to mask the sound of their pursuit. The howl of a prowler is distinctive, an ear-scrambling cacophony of taut wire scraping over rusted bones. To

hear such a noise is a clear warning to remain indoors, with doors barred and windows shuttered, lest it is death you seek.

Origin. In their efforts to build an arsenal of creatures with which to defend Luyarnha, the Scions explored the magic of chimerification. With threads of tin, these scientists stitched components harvested from eldritch corpses to the bodies of criminals and, with a burst of lightning, fused the rotting mass into a weak-willed and easily manipulable creature. But their weak will and eldritch blood made them susceptible to the influence of the Great Ones, who soon found new foot soldiers to add to their chaotic horde.

DEATH

In the forlorn Luyarnha, where clerics and hunters hold sway, magic capable of resurrecting the fallen is often called "The Call of Death." For those who have journeyed beyond the veil of mortality and dare return, an irremovable stain is left on their soul, beckoning their demise — "Death".

A monster that stalks those who have eluded the clutches of the grave, a creature whose sole purpose is to snuff out the lives of those who have defied their fate, Death's reputation is such that its mere mention is enough to send shivers down the spines of those afflicted.

No one knows for certain where Death came from or why it was unleashed upon the world, but its presence is a grim reminder of the fragility of life. Yet there are those who seek to defy this fate, who cling to life with a desperate fervor, willing to pay any price to cheat its relentless march, those who would think themselves above their kin, but to Death, their life has the same worth as that of a beggar's—two gold coins, which shall cover their eyes until it finds its next prey.



Death

Medium undead, lawful evil

Armor Class 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points 97 (15d8 + 30)

Speed 50 ft., climb 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	22 (+6)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +10, Wis +6, Cha +7

Skills Intimidation +11, Perception +10

Damage Resistances all

Damage Immunities bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered or moongilded

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, restrained

Senses blindsight 120 ft., truesight 120 ft., passive

Perception 20

Languages all

Challenge 12 (8,400 XP)

Blood Frenzy. Death has advantage on melee attack rolls made against any creature that doesn't have all its hit points.

Death's Embrace. A creature killed by Death can be restored to life only by a *wish* spell.

Magic Resistance. Death has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons. Death's weapon attacks are magical.

Turn Immunity. Death is immune to features that turn undead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Death uses its Whistle of Death and makes four claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (3d4 + 6) slashing damage, and the target gains one bleeding die if it's a creature.

A creature can have up to **ten** bleeding dice, which are d4s. A creature rolls its bleeding dice at the start of each of its turns, taking slashing damage equal to the total rolled. This damage can't be reduced in any way. Each time the creature regains hit points, the number of hit points it regains is halved and it loses one bleeding die.

A creature within 5 feet of a creature with one or more bleeding dice can use its action to make a Medicine check (DC 10 + the number of bleeding dice), removing all bleeding dice on a success. If the creature has a healer's kit, it can expend two uses of the kit to automatically succeed on the check.

Change Shape. Death magically polymorphs into a humanoid or beast that has a challenge rating no higher than its own, or back into its true form. It reverts to its true form if it dies. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying is absorbed or borne by the new form (Death's choice).

In a new form, Death retains its alignment, hit points, Hit Dice, ability to speak, proficiencies, and Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma scores, as well as this action. Its statistics and capabilities are otherwise replaced by those of the new form, except any class features or legendary actions of that form.

Whistle of Death. One creature of Death's choice within 120 feet of Death and aware of it must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 1 minute. A creature that has ever died automatically fails this saving throw. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to Death's Whistle of Death for the next 24 hours.

BONUS ACTIONS

Final Minute (1/Day). Death briefly stops the flow of time for all creatures except itself and one creature that it can see. No time passes for other creatures, while Death and the target take 1 minute, during which they can use actions and move as normal.

This effect ends if one of the actions Death uses or effects it creates during this period affects a creature other than it and its target or an object being worn or carried by a creature other than Death and its target. Death must concentrate on this ability (as if concentrating on a spell).

Scraping Charge. Death moves up to its speed in a straight line toward a target. If Death then hits it with its next claw attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 5 (1d10) slashing damage.

REACTIONS

Deflect. Death adds 4 to its AC against one attack that would hit it. To do so Death must see the attacker.

Close the Gap. When Death is targeted by a ranged weapon attack, it can teleport to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the attacker. To do so, Death must see the attacker.

DREAMER'S MINOR AVATAR

Dreamer's Minor Avatar

Large aberration, any evil

Armor Class 10
Hit Points 200 (16d10 + 112)
Speed 0 ft., swim 0 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	24 (+7)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	24 (+7)

Saving Throws Con +11, Int +9, Wis +9, Cha +11

Skills Perception +13

Damage Resistances poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from attacks that aren't moonbilled

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, stunned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages All, telepathy 300 ft.

Challenge 12 (8,400 XP)

Aberrant Mind. The avatar can maintain concentration on two spells at the same time. If it loses concentration, it loses both spells.

Aberrant Magic. Each time a creature fails a saving throw against a spell cast by the avatar, the creature also gains a short-term madness.

Fear Aura. Any creature hostile to the avatar that starts its turn within 30 feet of the avatar must make a DC 19 Wisdom saving throw, unless the avatar is incapacitated. On a failed save, the creature is frightened until the start of its next turn. If a creature's saving throw is successful, the creature is immune to the avatar's Fear Aura for the next 24 hours.

Gift of Guilt. Whenever a creature damages the avatar, the creature must succeed on a DC 19 Wisdom saving throw or be wracked with remorse for its actions and take psychic damage equal to the damage dealt.

Innate Spellcasting. The avatar's spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 19, +11 to hit with spell attacks). The avatar can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *misty step, sanctuary*

3/day each: *bludgeoning horror*† (5th level), *color spray* (5th level), *counterspell* (5th level), *dominate person*, *haste*, *mass healing word*, *sleep* (5th level)

1/day each: *hold monster*, *hypnotic pattern*, *mass cure wounds*, *modify memory* (9th level), *plane shift*, *wall of force*

Magic Resistance. The avatar has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Sanctified Being. The avatar is permanently under the effect of the *sanctuary* spell, and attacking, casting spells, and dealing damage doesn't end the spell.

ACTIONS

Mind Break. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +11 to hit, range 150 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 23 (3d10 + 7) psychic damage and the target can't take reactions until the start of its next turn.

Time Loop. The avatar chooses a creature it can see within 150 feet of it, attempting to force the creature to repeat itself. The target must succeed on a DC 19 Intelligence saving throw or, on its next turn, it is forced to use the same action and bonus action it performed on its previous turn. If the target can't perform the same action or bonus action (for example casting a spell because it is out of spell slots) it wastes the action and bonus action instead.

BONUS ACTIONS

Gift of Power. The avatar utters a word of power. Allied creatures within 60 feet of the avatar that can hear it gain a power die that can be added to any die roll once before it's expended. The die begins as a d4, but increase to a d8, d10, and finally a d12 each time Gift of Power is used on the creature prior to it expending the die.

"Our Slumbering Father that lies dormant, may you discover our worthless world; may you sink it beneath your waves; may you grant us a glimpse of your grandeur; guide us home."

Should a bold soul dare to infiltrate the submerged chapels of the Deep Ones, they would soon discover an unsettling truth. The figures that ornament the watery halls are no statues at all; they are in fact shards of the Slumbering One's power, poised to imbue the world with the incomprehensible gifts of their otherworldly patron.

Conjured through the arcane rituals of the Deep Ones, the Dreamer's Minor Avatars are embodiments of their master, made manifest within submerged sanctuaries. Resembling inert statues, these entities endow the Slumbering One's devout followers with minute portions of the power they ardently seek. These avatars are devoid of thought and emotion, their purpose inscrutable, yet their link to the Slumbering One is undeniable. Meaningless specks of dust erring through the cosmos, devoid of the grandeur of their progenitor, one must wonder if their father is even aware of the existence of such worthless and pathetic effigies.





SOUL-SNATCHING ARANEA

A soul-snatching aranea is a scourgeborne that has succumbed to its curse. When alive, it was a master of duplicity and lies, a more formidable deceiver than the rest of its kin, navigating the world through a web of manipulation. In a twist of fate, its madness revealed the monstrous personality beneath and gave it a more fitting form. Now truly accursed, this horror continues to use its skills to prey on the living.

These massive arachnids find refuge in the abandoned buildings of Luyarnha, turning them into their feeding ground. The aranea weaves illusions aimed at the unsuspecting, luring them in with sounds and visions of their closest loved ones. Rumors claim that it can imitate the sound of any person, past or present, with chilling accuracy. Once it has lured its victim close, it reveals its true form—a giant arachnid monstrosity of legs and fangs, a head dangling upside down, adorned with multiple eyes that gleam with a dark, sinister light—before leaping and devouring its prey's soul, leaving only the shell of a body behind.

One of the many reasons why “regular” araneas are despised is because of their soul-snatching cousins.

Soul-Snatching Aranea

Large monstrosity, any evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 190 (20d10 + 80)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	19 (+4)	18 (+4)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	19 (+4)

Saving Throws Cha +9

Skills Deception +14, Perception +5, Persuasion +9, Stealth +9

Damage Vulnerabilities radiant

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from attacks that aren't moonlighted or silvered

Condition Immunities charmed

Senses darkvision 120 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages Common, all languages any creatures whose souls it has eaten knew

Challenge 13 (10,000 XP)

Contorsion. The aranea can move through a space as narrow as 5 inches wide without squeezing.

Devour Soul. The aranea can eat the soul of a creature it has killed within the last hour, provided the creature has one. The devouring requires the aranea to be within 5 feet of the corpse for at least 10 minutes, after which it gains a number of Hit Dice (d10s) equal to half the creature's Hit Dice. Roll those dice, and increase the aranea's current hit points and hit point maximum by the total. For every four Hit Dice the aranea gains in this way, its attacks deal an extra 3 (1d6) damage on a hit. The aranea retains these benefits for 7 days. A creature whose soul is devoured by the aranea can be restored to life only by a *wish* spell.

Evasion. If the aranea is subjected to an effect that allows it to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, the aranea instead takes no damage if it succeeds on the saving throw, and only half damage if it fails.

Innate Spellcasting. The aranea's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 17). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *mage hand*, *minor illusion*, *prestidigitation*, *thaumaturgy*

3/day each: *blur*, *major image*, *silence*

1/day each: *mislead*, *phantasmal killer*

Snatcher's Mimicry. The aranea can perfectly imitate the voices of creatures whose souls it has devoured. The voice doesn't come from the aranea directly, echoing from its general direction instead. To discern the sound as unnatural and coming from the aranea, a creature can use its action to make a DC 17 Investigation check to inspect it, locating the origin of the voice on a success.

Spider Climb. The aranea can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Web Walker. The aranea ignores movement restrictions caused by webbing.

Web Sense. While in contact with a web, the aranea knows the exact location of any other creature in contact with the same web.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The aranea makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its legs.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 26 (4d10 + 4) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the creature finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0. In addition, the aranea regains hit points equal to half the damage dealt.

Leg. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Mimic Spell (3/Day). The aranea casts a spell of 5th level or lower with a verbal component and a casting time of 1 action it has heard cast within the last hour, without expending a spell slot or material components.

BONUS ACTIONS

Skitter. The aranea moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks

Web (Recharge 5-6). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, range 30/60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* The target is restrained by webbing. As an action, the restrained target can make a DC 17 Strength check, bursting the webbing on a success. The webbing can also be attacked and destroyed (AC 10; 20 hp; vulnerability to fire damage; immunity to bludgeoning, poison, and psychic damage).

REACTIONS

Yelp. After a creature the aranea can see hits it with an attack, the aranea can yelp in pain in the voice of one of the attacker's loved ones. The attacker must make a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, it takes 9 (2d8) psychic damage and can't target the aranea with any attacks or effects until the end of its turn.



ECTELLAX THE FLAYED

Ectellax, The Flayed was just an eldritch wyrmling when the God-Shaped Hole sent him to the Templum Praeteritum as a test for the mortal priests there. He was the last of the tests before the “Radiant One” vanished. Unlike the other eldritch sacrifices, Ectellax defeated the priests in the temple by directly tapping into the God-Shaped Hole’s power through the original eldritch carving. The exposure to this raw energy tore the flesh from his body, flaying him alive and leaving him in a constant state of agony.

Tempestuous Growth.

As the Radiant Church retreated and sealed the horrors away, Ectellax devoured the eldritch energy and grew faster than he would have otherwise. Now an adult, the dragon has gained a semblance of control over his enormous potential, and is ready to break through the sealed door leading to the Radiant Church and waits, desperate for his opportunity—even the monstrous gravitational fields he generates are useless against this eldritch prison.

Inherited Dreams.

Those of his kin share a collective memory that each newborn inherits—a gift of memory through flesh. Yet, the only thing that Ectellax has added to this wealth of knowledge is his despair. In his slumber, the memories of his ancestors possess him, tormenting him, rousing his anger and frustration, feelings that he is unable to act on. The visions of dragons soaring through the cosmos, bending foreign civilizations under their rule, or wiping them out of existence with their apocalyptic powers—sources of pride for his kind, and a painful reminder of his own helplessness.

Helpless Tyrant.

Trapped underground and cut off from the world, Ectellax’s mind has slowly unraveled. He has long lost the ability to distinguish between reality and dream; sometimes believing himself free, he hurls himself against the walls of his stone prison. The earth trembles and stone groans as the dragon thrashes about in his sleep, shaking the surface world in the crossfire of his nightmare. The proud being is now nothing more than a trapped and tormented soul. Ectellax’s long imprisonment has twisted his despotic intentions even further, turning them into a thirst for destruction and revenge. He longs to break free and unleash his fury on the world and the heavens, dethroning the so-called god that turned him into a puppet; but these remain hopeless wishes, as the barriers holding him underground remain unyielding.

Ectellax, The Played (Adult Eldritch Dragon)

Huge aberration & dragon, chaotic evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points 275 (22d12 + 154)
Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
27 (+8)	10 (+0)	25 (+7)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	23 (+6)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +13, Wis +7, Cha +12

Skills Insight +7, Perception +13, Persuasion +12, Stealth +6

Damage Resistances cold, necrotic, psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't moon-gilded

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, frightened

Senses blindsight 60 ft., darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages Deep Speech

Challenge 17 (18,000 XP)

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If the dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Maddened Mind. When a creature initiates telepathic contact with the dragon or attempts to read its mind, the creature must succeed on a DC 20 Intelligence saving throw or gain a short-term madness, as it witnesses the insanity the dragon holds.

Innate Spellcasting. The dragon's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 20, +12 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *gravity well*[†], *gravity storm*[†], *levitate*

3/day each: *astral barrage*[†], *fling*[†], *gravitational distortion*[†]

[†]SGttEH

Hatred of Radiance. When the dragon takes radiant damage, it goes into a blind rage, sacrificing its own body for power. The dragon takes 11 (2d10) necrotic damage, which can't be reduced in any way, and can take an additional legendary action before the start of its next turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon can use its Tyrant's Presence. It then makes two attacks: one with its bite and one with its claw.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (2d10 + 8) piercing damage plus 7 (2d6) psychic damage.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d6 + 8) slashing damage.

Tyrant's Presence. Each creature of the dragon's choice that is within 120 feet of the dragon and aware of it must succeed on a DC 20 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 1 minute. While frightened in this way, the creature also prostrates itself before the dragon, falling prone and unable to stand up. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to the dragon's Tyrant's Presence for the next 24 hours.

Cosmic Breath (Recharge 5-6). The dragon exhales a rush of void and stars in a 90-foot cone. Each creature in that area must make a DC 20 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 18 (4d8) necrotic damage and 18 (4d8) cold damage, and gains a short-term madness. On a successful save, the creature takes half as much damage and doesn't suffer any additional effect.

BONUS ACTIONS

Tentacle. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 15 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 12 (1d8 + 8) psychic damage. If the target is Huge or smaller, it is grappled (escape DC 22). The dragon can have up to four creatures grappled at a time.

Leap. The dragon uses 10 feet of movement to jump 30 feet.

REACTIONS

Dimension Warp. When a creature within 150 feet of the dragon targets it with a spell, the dragon can attempt to warp the world to swap positions with its assailant. The spellcaster must succeed on a DC 20 Charisma saving throw or exchange position with the dragon, becoming the new target of the spell.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The dragon can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The dragon regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Tentacle Attack. The dragon makes one tentacle attack.

Cast Spell (Costs 2 Actions). The dragon casts a spell.

Shatter Mind (Costs 2 Actions). The dragon targets a creature that it can see. The target must succeed on a DC 20 Intelligence saving throw or take 10 (3d6) psychic damage and gain a short-term madness. A creature the dragon is grappling automatically fails this saving throw.

ORR, THE GRIEVING REBIRTH

Orr, The Grieving Rebirth (First Form)

Huge aberration (god), chaotic evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points 262 (21d12 + 126)
Speed 40 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	10 (+0)	22 (+6)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	23 (+6)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +12, Int +9, Wis +10

Skills Arcana +9, Perception +10, Religion +15

Damage Immunities cold, psychic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, madness

Senses truesight 300 ft., passive Perception 20

Languages understands all but doesn't speak

Challenge 18 (20,000 XP)

Amorphous. Orr can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Cold Absorption. Whenever Orr is subjected to cold damage, it takes no damage and instead regains a number of hit points equal to the cold damage dealt.

Divine Rejuvenation. When Orr drops to 0 hit points, its body collapses into a writhing mass of flesh, whereupon Orr instantly reappears in its second form in an unoccupied space within 60 feet of where its first form was destroyed. Its initiative count doesn't change.

Freedom of Movement. Orr ignores difficult terrain, and magical effects can't reduce its speed or cause it to be restrained. It can spend 5 feet of movement to escape from nonmagical restraints or being grappled.

Immutable Form. Orr is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Innate Spellcasting. Orr's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 20, +12 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

3/day each: *divine order: reveal*[†], *fling*[†], *gravitational distortion*[†]

1/day each: *bury*[†], *crush*[†], *divine order: transcend*^{*†}

^{*}Orr always succeeds on the saving throw for this spell

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If Orr fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Magic Weapons. Orr's weapon attacks are magical.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Orr makes two tentacle attacks.

Tentacle, Melee Weapon Attack: +12 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (2d10 + 6) slashing damage and 13 (2d12) cold damage. If a creature is damaged by this attack twice before the start of Orr's next turn, it must succeed on a DC 20 Constitution saving throw or gain one level of exhaustion.

Scream (3/Day). Orr emits a scream of pure rage and agony. Each time it screams before finishing a long rest, the scream is louder and the effect is different, as detailed below. Each creature within 500 feet of Orr and able to hear the scream must make a DC 20 Constitution saving throw.

Scream of Pain. Each creature that fails its save is affected by crippling pain for 1 minute. For the duration, the creature's speeds are reduced to 10 feet and it has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws, other than Constitution saving throws. Further, if the target tries to cast a spell, it must first succeed on a DC 20 Constitution saving throw, or the casting fails and the spell is wasted. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Scream Of Harvest. Each creature that fails its save becomes vulnerable to necrotic and cold damage for 1 minute. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Scream of Death. Each creature takes 22 (4d10) cold damage and 22 (4d10) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful save.

BONUS ACTIONS

Teleport. Orr magically teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space.

REACTIONS

Warp Magic. Orr casts *counterspell* at 5th level.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Orr can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. Orr regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Tentacle Attack. Orr makes one tentacle attack.

Teleport (Costs 2 Actions). Orr uses Teleport.

Cast a Spell (Costs 3 Actions). Orr casts a spell from its Innate Spellcasting trait, expending a use as normal.



First Form



Second Form

The result of the union between two beings of power with nothing but hatred for each other. A weeping child unable to control its fury.

Orr, The Grieving Rebirth (Second Form)

Huge aberration (god), chaotic evil

Armor Class 23 (natural armor)
Hit Points 253 (22d12 + 110)
Speed 10 ft., fly 70 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	22 (+6)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	26 (+8)

Saving Throws Dex +12, Con +11, Int +9, Wis +10

Skills Acrobatics +18, Arcana +9, Perception +10, Religion +15

Damage Immunities cold, psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, madness

Senses truesight 300 ft., passive Perception 20

Languages understands all

Challenge 20 (25,000 XP)

Amorphous. Orr can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Black Frost Shell. Orr starts with 50 temporary hit points. If a creature hits it with a melee attack while it has these hit points, the creature takes 50 cold damage.

Freedom of Movement. Orr ignores difficult terrain, and magical effects can't reduce its speed or cause it to be restrained. It can spend 5 feet of movement to escape from nonmagical restraints or being grappled.

Gravity Bound. Orr is bound by its curse. It can't position itself further than 20 feet away vertically from the ground. If it is moved higher than 20 feet, it immediately begins falling until it is 20 feet above the ground.

Innate Spellcasting. Orr's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 22, +14 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

3/day each: *fling*[†]

1/day each: *bury*[‡], *divine order: sacrifice*[‡], *power word: kill*

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If Orr fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Magic Weapons. Orr's weapon attacks are magical.

Magic Resistance. Orr has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Numbing Frost. If Orr damages a creature twice on a turn, the target must make a DC 22 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target takes 17 (5d6) cold damage and is slowed, as per the *slow* spell, for 1 minute. On a successful save, the target takes half as much damage and isn't slowed. A slowed target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Orr uses its Frozen Rebirth. It then makes three tentacle attacks. It can replace up to two tentacle attacks with one maddening shard attack each.

Tentacle. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +12 to hit, reach 20 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (3d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage and 10 (3d6) cold damage, and Orr can push the target up to 30 feet away in a straight line.

Maddening Shard. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +14 to hit, range 150 ft., one target. *Hit:* 24 (3d10 + 8) cold damage, and if the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 22 Wisdom saving throw or gain a short-term madness.

Frozen Rebirth. Orr summons 1d4 hunters (SSgtEH page 319) in empty spaces it can see within 120 feet of it. The hunters are under Orr's control, are immune to cold damage, and gain a +4 bonus to attack and damage rolls. Orr can have no more than five hunters under its control at one time.

BONUS ACTIONS

Vanish. Orr explodes in a blast of rime and wind. Each creature within 60 feet of it must make a DC 22 Constitution saving throw, taking 17 (5d6) cold damage on a failure, or half as much damage on a success. Creatures touching metal objects (for example, carrying metal weapons or wearing metal armor) automatically fail this saving throw. Orr then reappears in an unoccupied space of its choice that it can see within 120 feet of it.

REACTIONS

Devour Magic. When a creature Orr can see within 60 feet of it casts a spell, Orr casts *counterspell* at 5th level. If it successfully counters the magic, it regains hit points equal to three times the spell's level (0 for cantrips).

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Orr can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. Orr regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Tentacle Attack. Orr makes one tentacle attack.

Teleport (Costs 1 Actions). Orr uses its Vanish.

Cast a Spell (Costs 2 Actions). Orr casts a spell from its Innate Spellcasting trait, expending a use as normal.